STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT

MGT603

MCQS AND SHORT QUESTIONS FILE FOR

FINAL TERM

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LESSON 19

Lesson 19: Types of Strategies from Strategic Management (MGT603):

✓ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. What is the main goal of horizontal integration?

A) Decrease product prices

B) Increase employee motivation

C) Gain control over competitors ✓

D) Improve product differentiation

2. Which of the following is **not** one of Michael Porter's generic strategies?

A) Differentiation

B) Cost Leadership

C) Integration

D) Focus ✓

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3. When is horizontal integration most effective?

A) When industry sales are declining

B) When the firm has no capital

C) When competitors are faltering ✓

D) When the government is likely to intervene

4. Cost leadership strategy focuses on:

A) High product pricing

B) Unique features

C) Low per-unit production costs ✓

D) Customer intimacy

5. Differentiation strategy is best suited when:

A) Customers seek low prices

B) Customers want unique products ✓

C) There's no competition

D) Government regulations are strict

6. A firm pursuing a focus strategy:

A) Targets a broad market

B) Competes in all industries

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C) Concentrates on a specific market segment ✓

D) Always chooses cost over quality

7. What is one primary risk of cost leadership strategy?

A) High profit margins

B) Brand loyalty

C) Easy imitation by competitors ✓

D) Increased advertising costs

8. Which of these is an example of a company following cost leadership?

A) Apple

B) Rolls-Royce

C) McDonald's ✓

D) Ferrari

9. The differentiation strategy benefits from:

A) Low-cost suppliers only

B) High price sensitivity

C) Unique product features ✓

D) Low-skilled labor

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10. Which strategy allows a firm to charge premium prices?

A) Cost Focus

B) Cost Leadership

C) Differentiation ✓

D) Integration

11. Focus strategies are mostly used by:

A) Global companies

B) Governmental agencies

C) Small firms ✓

D) NGOs

12. What is a potential benefit of horizontal integration?

A) More government regulation

B) Higher production costs

C) Increased economies of scale ✓

D) Fewer suppliers

13. Porter recommends performing what type of analysis among business units?

A) Market-share

B) Resource

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C) Cost-benefit ✓

D) SWOT

14. In cost leadership, efficiency is achieved through:

A) Luxury branding

B) Small-scale production

C) High-volume production ✓

D) Creative advertising

15. Which of the following is a characteristic of cost leadership firms?

A) Strong creative skills

B) High overhead costs

C) Tight cost control ✓

D) Premium pricing

16. What is a key characteristic of focus strategy?

A) Targets many customers

B) High advertising costs

C) Niche marketing ✓

D) Broad distribution

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17. Which is **not** typically needed for a differentiation strategy?

A) Strong R&D

B) High creativity

C) Tight cost control ✓

D) Skilled marketing

18. What term did Treacy & Wiersema use for value creation based on strong operations?

A) Focus

B) Operational excellence ✓

C) Cost control

D) Product leadership

19. According to Millar, what criticism is made of Porter's strategies?

A) They are too flexible

B) They are too easy to implement

C) They lack specificity ✓

D) They focus too much on customers

20. A major threat to cost leadership is:

A) High customer loyalty

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B) Competitor imitation ✅

C) Brand differentiation

D) Market monopoly

✅ 10 Short Answer Questions

1. What is horizontal integration in strategic management?

→ It is a strategy of gaining ownership or control over competitors in the same industry.

2. Name the three generic strategies proposed by Michael Porter.

→ Cost leadership, differentiation, and focus.

3. How does a cost leadership strategy help a firm?

→ It enables the firm to produce goods at low cost and offer them at competitive prices, targeting price-sensitive customers.

4. What type of companies usually adopt focus strategies?

→ Smaller firms that target niche markets.

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5. What are some key requirements for a successful differentiation strategy?

→ Strong R&D, creativity, product innovation, and effective marketing.

6. When is horizontal integration especially effective?

→ When competitors are weak, the industry is growing, and the firm has the resources to manage expansion.

7. What are the risks of a cost leadership strategy?

→ Competitor imitation, technological changes, and reduced buyer interest in low-cost features.

8. How does differentiation reduce price elasticity?

→ By creating unique products, customers become less sensitive to price changes and more brand loyal.

9. What is a "focus" strategy according to Porter?

→ A strategy where a firm targets a specific market segment with tailored products/services.

10. What are Treacy and Wiersema's three value disciplines?

→ Operational excellence, product innovation, and customer intimacy.

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LESSON 20

Lesson 20: Types of Strategies (Intensive Strategies) from *Strategic Management – MGT603*:

✅ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. Which of the following is **not** an intensive strategy?

A) Market penetration

B) Product development

C) Market development

D) Horizontal integration ✅

2. Market penetration involves:

A) Creating new products

B) Entering new markets

C) Selling existing products in current markets ✅

D) Expanding into unrelated industries

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3. Which strategy is about introducing current products into new geographic areas?

A) Market penetration

B) Market development ✓

C) Product development

D) Diversification

4. Which is **most accurate** about product development?

A) It focuses on cost cutting

B) It involves minor changes to existing markets

C) It emphasizes innovation and R&D ✓

D) It targets reducing advertising costs

5. What is the main goal of market penetration?

A) Develop new products

B) Attract new markets

C) Increase market share in current markets ✓

D) Form joint ventures

6. Market penetration can be achieved by all except:

A) Increasing sales force

B) Offering promotional items

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C) Entering foreign markets ✓

D) Increasing publicity

7. What condition supports using a market penetration strategy?

A) New product launch

B) Highly saturated market

C) Competitors' market share declining ✓

D) Entering a declining industry

8. Rapid market penetration involves:

A) Lowering price and increasing promotion ✓

B) Lowering quality and cost

C) Increasing price and promotion

D) Increasing price only

9. Slow market penetration includes:

A) Increased promotional campaigns

B) Decreased prices and unchanged promotion ✓

C) Entry into new regions

D) Reduced customer service

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10. Which of these **best fits** the market development strategy?

A) Launching a new product in an existing city

B) Offering the same product in a new city ✓

C) Upgrading an existing product

D) Retiring old products

11. Which of these is a favorable condition for market development?

A) High advertising costs

B) Lack of capital

C) Presence of untapped markets ✓

D) Saturated foreign markets

12. Which of the following is **not** a guideline for product development?

A) Strong R&D

B) Product in growth stage ✓

C) Industry with rapid tech changes

D) Competing in high-growth industry

13. What is a major requirement for successful product development?

A) Increased advertising

B) Strong research and development ✓

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C) Entering global markets

D) Reducing quality

14. An example of product development is:

A) Selling the same product in another country

B) Offering online postage solutions ✓

C) Hiring more salespeople

D) Reducing product price

15. When is product development **most effective**?

A) Product is in decline stage

B) Industry is stagnant

C) Product is in maturity stage ✓

D) Market is saturated

16. Market development is attractive when:

A) Company lacks resources

B) Company has excess production capacity ✓

C) All competitors are global

D) Product demand is falling

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17. Which of the following is **true** about intensive strategies?

A) They focus on diversification

B) They are used to exit a market

C) They seek to improve competitive position using current products ✓

D) They are best suited for government agencies

18. What industry trend makes market development more favorable?

A) Industry becoming localized

B) Industry becoming global ✓

C) Industry in decline

D) Regulatory tightening

19. Market penetration is **not effective** when:

A) Current market is saturated ✓

B) Promotion costs are low

C) Competitors are weak

D) Customers can increase usage

20. The use of digital stamps by postal services is an example of:

A) Market penetration

B) Market development

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C) Product development ✓

D) Diversification

✓ 10 Short Answer Questions

1. What are the three intensive strategies in strategic management?

→ Market penetration, market development, and product development.

2. Define market penetration strategy.

→ It aims to increase market share for existing products in current markets through aggressive marketing efforts.

3. List two methods used in market penetration.

→ Increasing advertising and expanding the sales force.

4. When is market penetration most effective?

→ When current markets are not saturated and competitors' market shares are declining.

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5. What is the key difference between rapid and slow market penetration?

→ Rapid involves both lowering price and increasing promotion; slow involves lowering price only.

6. What is the goal of a market development strategy?

→ To introduce existing products into new geographic or demographic markets.

7. Name two situations where market development is an effective strategy.

→ When untapped markets exist and the firm has excess production capacity.

8. What does product development focus on?

→ Creating or improving existing products to boost sales.

9. Provide one real-world example of product development.

→ The U.S. Postal Service offering PC Postage via the internet.

10. When should a firm pursue product development?

→ When products are in the maturity stage and there are strong R&D capabilities.

LESSON 21

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Lesson 21: Types of Strategies (Diversification & Defensive Strategies) from *Strategic Management – MGT603*.

✓ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. Which of the following is **not** a type of diversification strategy?

A) Horizontal

B) Vertical ✓

C) Concentric

D) Conglomerate

2. Concentric diversification involves:

A) Selling off assets

B) Adding new, related products or services ✓

C) Entering completely unrelated industries

D) Focusing only on one product

3. Which of the following is an example of concentric diversification?

A) A clothing brand starts producing fertilizer

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B) A telecom company adds cable services ✓

C) A car company opens a hospital

D) A book publisher sells groceries

4. When is concentric diversification most effective?

A) When products are in growth stage

B) When entering a saturated market

C) When current products are declining and new related ones can boost sales ✓

D) When no R&D is available

5. Conglomerate diversification means:

A) Entering related industries

B) Introducing new products to the same market

C) Entering totally unrelated industries ✓

D) Focusing on a niche market

6. Which is a valid reason for conglomerate diversification?

A) To reduce employee turnover

B) To achieve financial synergy ✓

C) To increase brand loyalty

D) To reuse old equipment

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7. When should a firm pursue conglomerate diversification?

A) When current sales are increasing rapidly

B) When product life cycle is in introduction

C) When existing markets are saturated ✓

D) When facing high profitability

8. Horizontal diversification involves:

A) Adding related products

B) Adding unrelated products for new customers

C) Adding unrelated products for existing customers ✓

D) Reducing production

9. What reduces the risk of horizontal diversification compared to conglomerate diversification?

A) Use of external distributors

B) Focus on high-growth markets

C) Familiarity with existing customers ✓

D) Entering new international markets

10. Which of these is **not** a benefit of horizontal diversification?

A) Higher product risk ✓

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B) Use of existing distribution channels

C) Reaching current customers with new products

D) Counter-cyclical sales

11. What kind of diversification adds new unrelated products for present customers?

A) Concentric

B) Horizontal ✓

C) Vertical

D) Conglomerate

12. Which strategy is **most appropriate** when a company has declining sales and strong management?

A) Market development

B) Concentric diversification ✓

C) Liquidation

D) Horizontal integration

13. What is a defensive strategy?

A) Product development

B) Diversification

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C) Retrenchment ✓

D) Market expansion

14. Retrenchment is also known as:

A) Diversification

B) Turnaround or reorganization ✓

C) Expansion

D) Stabilization

15. Which of the following would be used in retrenchment?

A) Increasing advertising

B) Hiring more staff

C) Automating processes and reducing costs ✓

D) Entering new markets

16. When is retrenchment an effective strategy?

A) Firm has growing profits

B) Firm is expanding quickly

C) Firm has failed to meet objectives over time ✓

D) Firm is entering a new market

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17. What is a sign that retrenchment may be needed?

A) Rising employee morale

B) Consistently high market share

C) Inefficiency and low profitability ✓

D) Declining competition

18. Which defensive strategy involves selling off a business unit?

A) Retrenchment

B) Liquidation

C) Divestiture ✓

D) Horizontal integration

19. Which strategy is used when a company shuts down operations permanently and sells assets?

A) Divestiture

B) Retrenchment

C) Liquidation ✓

D) Market penetration

20. Which of the following is **not** a defensive strategy?

A) Divestiture

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B) Liquidation

C) Product development ✓

D) Retrenchment

✓ 10 Short Answer Questions

1. Name the three types of diversification strategies.

→ Concentric, Horizontal, Conglomerate.

2. What is concentric diversification?

→ Adding new but related products or services.

3. Provide one condition favoring concentric diversification.

→ Current products are in the decline stage of their life cycle.

4. Define conglomerate diversification.

→ Adding new, unrelated products or services.

5. Give one guideline when conglomerate diversification is suitable.

→ When current markets are saturated or declining.

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6. What is horizontal diversification?

→ Adding new, unrelated products or services for current customers.

7. Name one advantage of horizontal diversification.

→ Leverages existing customer base and distribution channels.

8. What is retrenchment strategy?

→ A cost-reduction and asset-reduction strategy to reverse declining sales and profits.

9. List two actions that might be taken during retrenchment.

→ Closing factories, reducing workforce.

10. When is retrenchment appropriate?

→ When a firm consistently fails to meet objectives and has internal inefficiencies.

LESSON 22

Lesson 22: Types of Strategies (Defensive Strategies, Joint Ventures) from *Strategic Management – MGT603*.

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✓ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. What does *divestiture* refer to?

A) Buying new firms

B) Selling a division or part of an organization ✓

C) Investing in technology

D) Restructuring departments

2. Divestiture is often used to:

A) Expand product lines

B) Raise capital for strategic acquisitions ✓

C) Increase employee count

D) Launch IPO

3. Which of the following is a guideline for divestiture?

A) When a firm is highly profitable

B) When a division is a good strategic fit

C) When a division is a misfit with the rest of the organization ✓

D) When there is no need for capital

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4. What kind of companies typically use divestiture to focus on core strengths?

A) Startups

B) Large conglomerates ✓

C) Nonprofits

D) Educational institutions

5. Which company divested multiple divisions to become solely an athletic footwear company?

A) Adidas

B) Nike

C) Venator Group ✓

D) Puma

6. Which of the following is an example of divestiture?

A) Microsoft selling Sidewalk Entertainment ✓

B) Nestlé forming Ice Cream Partners USA

C) Ford and EBay launching CarPoint

D) Merging with a supplier

7. What does *liquidation* involve?

A) Outsourcing operations

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B) Selling all company assets for tangible value ✓

C) Investing in R&D

D) Merging with another firm

8. When is liquidation considered an effective strategy?

A) When market share increases

B) When expansion is planned

C) When retrenchment and divestiture have failed ✓

D) When employees demand higher wages

9. Which of the following is **not** a reason to consider liquidation?

A) Bankruptcy is the only alternative

B) Company wants to expand into new markets ✓

C) Retrenchment and divestiture have failed

D) Asset sale helps minimize shareholder losses

10. Liquidation is best described as:

A) A growth strategy

B) A profit maximization method

C) A recognition of defeat ✓

D) A product development tactic

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11. What is a joint venture?

A) A hostile takeover

B) A complete merger

C) A temporary partnership to exploit an opportunity ✓

D) An internal cost-cutting strategy

12. Joint ventures are commonly formed to:

A) Increase product prices

B) Expand inventory

C) Capitalize on an opportunity with shared risk ✓

D) Automate internal processes

13. Which of the following is **not** a type of cooperative arrangement?

A) Cross-manufacturing

B) Cross-distribution

C) Internal auditing ✓

D) Cross-licensing

14. Which companies formed *Ice Cream Partners USA*?

A) Ford and Microsoft

B) Nestlé and Pillsbury ✓

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C) AOL and Bertelsmann

D) AOL and Disney

15. A joint venture between a domestic and foreign firm is beneficial because:

A) It removes the need for R&D

B) It reduces local market risks ✓

C) It increases bureaucracy

D) It eliminates taxation

16. Which of these is a valid reason to pursue a joint venture?

A) Avoiding accountability

B) Reducing product costs

C) Introducing a new technology quickly ✓

D) Protecting trade secrets

17. Joint ventures are increasingly used because they:

A) Avoid international markets

B) Increase risk

C) Improve networking and communication ✓

D) Eliminate branding

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18. Which joint venture resulted in *AOL Europe*?

A) AOL + Disney

B) AOL + Infoseek

C) AOL + Bertelsmann AG ✓

D) AOL + Ford

19. What is an example of a joint venture in the automotive industry?

A) Pillsbury + Nestlé

B) Porsche + Pacific Century Group ✓

C) IBM + Compaq

D) Kellogg + Lender's Bagels

20. When is a joint venture especially effective?

A) When all firms are publicly held

B) When one firm is declining

C) When resources and risks are overwhelming, but the project is profitable ✓

D) When the market is saturated

✓ 10 Short Answer Questions

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1. What is divestiture?

→ Selling a division or part of an organization, often to raise capital or eliminate a poor-performing unit.

2. List one reason a company may pursue divestiture.

→ When a division is responsible for the firm's poor overall performance.

3. Give one example of a company that used divestiture.

→ Microsoft divested Sidewalk Entertainment.

4. What is liquidation?

→ Selling all of a company's assets, in parts, for their tangible worth.

5. When is liquidation appropriate?

→ When retrenchment and divestiture fail, or to avoid bankruptcy.

6. What is a joint venture?

→ A temporary partnership between two or more firms to capitalize on an opportunity.

7. Name one recent joint venture and the companies involved.

→ Ice Cream Partners USA – formed by Nestlé and Pillsbury.

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8. What are two types of cooperative arrangements?

→ Cross-distribution agreements and research and development partnerships.

9. Why are joint ventures becoming more popular?

→ They help globalize operations, improve communication, and reduce risk.

10. Name one situation where a joint venture is particularly effective.

→ When complementary competencies exist between the firms.

LESSON 23 & 24

Lesson 23: Strategy-Formulation Framework and **Lesson 24: TOWS Matrix** combined for your study.

Lesson 23 & 24: MCQs (with Answers)

1. **Which of the following is NOT part of Stage 1 in the strategy-formulation framework?**

   a) EFE Matrix

   b) Competitive Profile Matrix

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c) QSPM

d) IFE Matrix

Answer: c) QSPM

2. **The TOWS Matrix is also known as:**

   a) BCG Matrix

   b) SWOT Analysis

   c) SPACE Matrix

   d) IE Matrix

   Answer: b) SWOT Analysis

3. **Which matrix is used in Stage 3 of the strategy-formulation framework?**

   a) SPACE Matrix

   b) IE Matrix

   c) QSPM

   d) TOWS Matrix

   Answer: c) QSPM

4. **What does the WO strategy in the TOWS Matrix focus on?**

   a) Using strengths to exploit opportunities

   b) Using strengths to avoid threats

   c) Overcoming weaknesses by taking advantage of opportunities

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d) Minimizing weaknesses and avoiding threats

Answer: c) Overcoming weaknesses by taking advantage of opportunities

5. **Which of the following is an internal factor in the TOWS Matrix?**

   a) Opportunities

   b) Threats

   c) Strengths

   d) Political environment

   Answer: c) Strengths

6. **What is the main purpose of the Competitive Profile Matrix?**

   a) To evaluate internal weaknesses

   b) To analyze external opportunities

   c) To identify a firm's major competitors and their strengths and weaknesses

   d) To select strategies objectively

   Answer: c) To identify a firm's major competitors and their strengths and weaknesses

7. **The SPACE Matrix is used to:**

   a) Match internal and external factors

   b) Quantitatively select strategies

   c) Evaluate competitive position

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d) Identify strengths and weaknesses

Answer: a) Match internal and external factors

8. **Which strategy in TOWS is designed to minimize weaknesses and avoid threats?**

   a) SO

   b) WO

   c) ST

   d) WT

   Answer: d) WT

9. **Which of the following best describes the role of the board of directors in strategy formulation?**

   a) They are solely responsible for strategy analysis

   b) They have no role in strategy formulation

   c) They provide oversight and guidance in the strategic decision-making process

   d) They develop all strategic plans independently

   Answer: c) They provide oversight and guidance in the strategic decision-making process

10. **Which matrix helps an organization evaluate business units or product lines based on market growth and market share?**

    a) IE Matrix

    b) BCG Matrix

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c) QSPM

d) SPACE Matrix

Answer: b) BCG Matrix

11. **What is a major limitation of SWOT/TOWS analysis?**

    a) It always gives the same result regardless of the evaluator

    b) It requires numerical data only

    c) It is highly subjective and varies between analysts

    d) It excludes external factors

    Answer: c) It is highly subjective and varies between analysts

12. **Which of the following is a tool used during the matching stage of strategy formulation?**

    a) EFE Matrix

    b) IFE Matrix

    c) TOWS Matrix

    d) QSPM

    Answer: c) TOWS Matrix

13. **The EFE Matrix evaluates:**

    a) Internal strengths and weaknesses

    b) External opportunities and threats

    c) Competitive strengths of rivals

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d) Quantitative strategic options

Answer: b) External opportunities and threats

14. **A firm's financial strength would be considered a:**

    a) Threat

    b) Weakness

    c) Opportunity

    d) Strength

    Answer: d) Strength

15. **The primary purpose of the QSPM is to:**

    a) Identify external threats

    b) Generate strategic alternatives

    c) Objectively evaluate and prioritize strategies

    d) Analyze competitive position

    Answer: c) Objectively evaluate and prioritize strategies

16. **Which of the following best describes a SO Strategy?**

    a) Using internal weaknesses to avoid threats

    b) Using strengths to take advantage of opportunities

    c) Minimizing weaknesses and threats

    d) Using strengths to avoid threats

    Answer: b) Using strengths to take advantage of opportunities

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17. **According to the lesson, excessive reliance on analytical tools in strategy formulation may lead to:**

    a) Increased organizational learning

    b) Reduced discussion and false sense of certainty

    c) More subjective decisions

    d) Ignoring quantitative data

    Answer: b) Reduced discussion and false sense of certainty

18. **A strong competitor entering the market is considered a:**

    a) Strength

    b) Opportunity

    c) Threat

    d) Weakness

    Answer: c) Threat

19. **Which technique is NOT part of the Matching Stage?**

    a) BCG Matrix

    b) QSPM

    c) TOWS Matrix

    d) SPACE Matrix

    Answer: b) QSPM

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20. **In the strategy-formulation framework, 'inputs' refer to:**

    a) Strategies to be implemented

    b) Information and data from internal and external analysis

    c) Decision-making in the boardroom

    d) Financial investments

    Answer: b) Information and data from internal and external analysis

---

Short Questions & Answers

1. **Q:** What are the three stages of the strategy-formulation framework?

   A: Stage 1: Input Stage (EFE, IFE, Competitive Profile Matrix), Stage 2: Matching Stage (TOWS, SPACE, BCG, IE, Grand Strategy Matrix), Stage 3: Decision Stage (QSPM).

2. **Q:** Define the TOWS Matrix.

   A: A strategic planning tool that matches internal strengths and weaknesses with external opportunities and threats to develop strategic options.

3. **Q:** What does the EFE Matrix evaluate?

   A: External factors, specifically opportunities and threats that affect the organization.

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4. **Q:** What is the role of the QSPM?

   A: To objectively evaluate feasible alternative strategies and prioritize them based on input data from earlier stages.

5. **Q:** Differentiate between strengths and opportunities in TOWS.

   A: Strengths are internal attributes helpful to achieving objectives, while opportunities are external conditions that can be exploited.

6. **Q:** Why is strategy formulation not solely dependent on analytic tools?

   A: Because intuition, judgment, and human factors like politics, culture, and ethics also influence strategic decisions.

7. **Q:** Name two internal factors and two external factors considered in strategy formulation.

   A: Internal: Strengths and Weaknesses; External: Opportunities and Threats.

8. **Q:** What does a WO strategy aim to achieve?

   A: To overcome internal weaknesses by exploiting external opportunities.

9. **Q:** What is the significance of ranking factors in TOWS analysis?

   A: It helps prioritize the most important strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats to develop effective strategies.

10. **Q:** How can overreliance on numerical tools negatively affect strategy formulation?

    A: It may reduce dialogue and critical discussion, leading to less organizational learning and potential bias in decision-making.

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LESSON 25 & 26

Lesson 25 & 26: The Strategic Position and Action Evaluation (SPACE) Matrix

for your study.

Lesson 25 & 26: MCQs (with Answers)

1. **What does the SPACE Matrix primarily evaluate?**

   a) Internal resources only

   b) External environment only

   c) Both internal and external strategic positions

   d) Financial statements only

   Answer: c) Both internal and external strategic positions

2. **Which of the following is NOT an internal dimension in the SPACE Matrix?**

   a) Financial Strength (FS)

   b) Competitive Advantage (CA)

   c) Environmental Stability (ES)

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d) None of the above

Answer: c) Environmental Stability (ES)

3. **In the SPACE Matrix, the rating scale for Financial Strength ranges from:**

   a) -6 (worst) to +6 (best)

   b) +1 (worst) to +6 (best)

   c) -1 (best) to -6 (worst)

   d) 0 to 10

   Answer: b) +1 (worst) to +6 (best)

4. **Which quadrant of the SPACE Matrix suggests an aggressive strategy?**

   a) First quadrant

   b) Second quadrant

   c) Third quadrant

   d) Fourth quadrant

   Answer: a) First quadrant

5. **Competitive Advantage (CA) in the SPACE Matrix is rated on a scale from:**

   a) +1 to +6

   b) -1 to -6

   c) 0 to 5

   d) 1 to 10

   Answer: b) -1 to -6

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6. **Which of the following is an external dimension in the SPACE Matrix?**

   a) Competitive Advantage

   b) Industry Strength

   c) Financial Strength

   d) Working Capital

   Answer: b) Industry Strength

7. **Environmental Stability in the SPACE Matrix includes all EXCEPT:**

   a) Impact of technology

   b) Price elasticity of demand

   c) Market share

   d) Political situation

   Answer: c) Market share

8. **What does a vector pointing towards the 'defensive' quadrant indicate?**

   a) The firm should pursue growth aggressively

   b) The firm should avoid risks and defend its position

   c) The firm is in a strong competitive position

   d) The firm should invest in new markets

   Answer: b) The firm should avoid risks and defend its position

9. **The Industry Strength (IS) rating scale is:**

   a) +1 (worst) to +6 (best)

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b) -1 (best) to -6 (worst)

c) -6 to +6

d) 0 to 10

Answer: a) +1 (worst) to +6 (best)

10. **Which variable is NOT considered part of Financial Strength?**

    a) Return on Investment

    b) Working Capital

    c) Customer Loyalty

    d) Debt to Equity Ratio

    Answer: c) Customer Loyalty

11. **How many main variables does the SPACE Matrix evaluate?**

    a) Two

    b) Four

    c) Six

    d) Eight

    Answer: b) Four

12. **Which step is NOT part of preparing a SPACE Matrix?**

    a) Assign numerical values to variables

    b) Develop TOWS strategies

    c) Compute average scores

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d) Plot the scores on the matrix

Answer: b) Develop TOWS strategies

13. **What is the correct sequence for plotting the SPACE Matrix axes?**

    a) X-axis: Financial Strength and Industry Strength; Y-axis: Competitive Advantage and Environmental Stability

    b) X-axis: Environmental Stability and Competitive Advantage; Y-axis: Financial Strength and Industry Strength

    c) X-axis: Financial Strength and Competitive Advantage; Y-axis: Industry Strength and Environmental Stability

    d) X-axis: Financial Strength and Industry Strength; Y-axis: Environmental Stability and Competitive Advantage

    Answer: d) X-axis: Financial Strength and Industry Strength; Y-axis: Environmental Stability and Competitive Advantage

14. **If a firm scores high on financial strength and industry strength but low on environmental stability and competitive advantage, which strategy is most likely recommended?**

    a) Aggressive

    b) Conservative

    c) Defensive

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d) Competitive

Answer: a) Aggressive

15. **Which of the following best defines 'Environmental Stability'?**

a) Firm's internal working capital

b) External factors like political situation and technology impact

c) Market share and customer loyalty

d) Debt to equity ratio

Answer: b) External factors like political situation and technology impact

16. **In the SPACE Matrix, Competitive Advantage scores are negative because:**

a) Higher competitive advantage is worse

b) Negative scores indicate the firm's relative weaknesses in the competitive environment

c) The matrix follows a convention where these are rated negatively

d) It is a mistake; they should be positive

Answer: c) The matrix follows a convention where these are rated negatively

17. **A firm with scores FS=4, IS=5, ES=-3, CA=-2 will most likely adopt:**

a) Aggressive strategy

b) Defensive strategy

c) Conservative strategy

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d) Competitive strategy

Answer: a) Aggressive strategy

18. **Which of the following is TRUE about the SPACE Matrix?**

a) It is used only for financial analysis

b) It provides a graphical representation of strategic position

c) It ignores external environmental factors

d) It always suggests defensive strategies

Answer: b) It provides a graphical representation of strategic position

19. **Which factor is considered under Industry Strength in the SPACE Matrix?**

a) Rate of inflation

b) Capital intensity

c) Price elasticity of demand

d) Access to the market

Answer: b) Capital intensity

20. **The direction vector in the SPACE Matrix helps to:**

a) Calculate financial ratios

b) Identify the best product mix

c) Recommend a strategic posture for the firm

d) Assess employee satisfaction

Answer: c) Recommend a strategic posture for the firm

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Short Questions & Answers

1. **Q:** What are the four dimensions of the SPACE Matrix?

   A: Financial Strength (FS), Competitive Advantage (CA), Environmental Stability (ES), and Industry Strength (IS).

2. **Q:** How are Financial Strength and Industry Strength rated in the SPACE Matrix?

   A: They are rated on a scale from +1 (worst) to +6 (best).

3. **Q:** What is the rating scale for Competitive Advantage and Environmental Stability?

   A: They are rated from -1 (best) to -6 (worst).

4. **Q:** What does the vector in the SPACE Matrix indicate?

   A: The recommended strategic posture (aggressive, competitive, conservative, or defensive) based on the firm's position.

5. **Q:** Why are some ratings negative in the SPACE Matrix?

   A: Negative ratings represent factors where lower values indicate better conditions, like competitive advantage and environmental stability.

6. **Q:** List two internal variables assessed in the SPACE Matrix.

   A: Financial strength and competitive advantage.

7. **Q:** List two external variables assessed in the SPACE Matrix.

   A: Environmental stability and industry strength.

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8. **Q:** What strategic posture should a firm adopt if it falls in the conservative quadrant?

   A: It should protect its current position by focusing on stability and cautious growth.

9. **Q:** Describe a scenario where a firm would adopt a defensive strategy based on SPACE Matrix analysis.

   A: When it has weak financial strength and industry strength and faces a highly unstable environment and strong competition.

10. **Q:** What is the first step in preparing a SPACE Matrix?

    A: Selecting variables related to the four dimensions: FS, CA, ES, and IS.

LESSON 27 & 28

Lesson 27 & 28: BCG Matrix and IE Matrix based on the material you shared.

Lesson 27 & 28: MCQs (with Answers)

1. **Who founded the Boston Consulting Group (BCG)?**

   a) Michael Porter

   b) Bruce Henderson

   c) Peter Drucker

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d) Henry Mintzberg

Answer: b) Bruce Henderson

2. **What are the two key dimensions used in the BCG Matrix?**

   a) Market growth rate and relative market share

   b) Financial strength and competitive advantage

   c) Internal factors and external factors

   d) Industry strength and environmental stability

   Answer: a) Market growth rate and relative market share

3. **In the BCG Matrix, which category represents units with high market share in a slow-growing industry?**

   a) Stars

   b) Dogs

   c) Cash cows

   d) Question marks

   Answer: c) Cash cows

4. **What is the main goal of the 'Question marks' category in the BCG Matrix?**

   a) To divest immediately

   b) To maintain current position

   c) To convert them into stars

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d) To become dogs

Answer: c) To convert them into stars

5. **Which BCG category typically generates cash in excess of what is needed to maintain the business?**

   a) Stars

   b) Dogs

   c) Cash cows

   d) Question marks

   Answer: c) Cash cows

6. **According to the BCG Matrix, what should be done with 'Dogs'?**

   a) Invest heavily

   b) Milk them continuously

   c) Sell or divest

   d) Convert into stars

   Answer: c) Sell or divest

7. **What does the size of the circle in the BCG Matrix represent?**

   a) Market growth rate

   b) Relative market share

   c) Sales value of the product or business unit

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d) Profit margin

Answer: c) Sales value of the product or business unit

8. **Relative market share in the BCG Matrix is calculated against:**

   a) The market leader

   b) The smallest competitor

   c) The average competitor

   d) The company itself

   Answer: a) The market leader

9. **Which of the following is NOT a limitation of the BCG Matrix?**

   a) Over-simplifies business units into four categories

   b) Does not consider time trends in growth

   c) Considers many variables besides market share and growth

   d) Many businesses don't fit neatly into categories

   Answer: c) Considers many variables besides market share and growth

10. **In the BCG Matrix, what does a high relative market share indicate?**

    a) Lower cash generation

    b) Higher cash generation

    c) Higher risk

    d) No impact on cash generation

    Answer: b) Higher cash generation

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11. **The IE Matrix relates to which two types of factor evaluations?**

    a) SWOT and TOWS

    b) IFE and EFE

    c) FS and CA

    d) IS and ES

    Answer: b) IFE and EFE

12. **What are the axes in the IE Matrix?**

    a) Market growth rate (y-axis) and relative market share (x-axis)

    b) IFE total weighted score (x-axis) and EFE total weighted score (y-axis)

    c) Financial strength (y-axis) and competitive advantage (x-axis)

    d) Profitability (x-axis) and risk (y-axis)

    Answer: b) IFE total weighted score (x-axis) and EFE total weighted score (y-axis)

13. **Which IE Matrix cells suggest a strategy of 'Grow and Build'?**

    a) I, II, IV

    b) III, V, VII

    c) VI, VIII, IX

    d) All cells

    Answer: a) I, II, IV

14. **In the IE Matrix, an IFE score of 3.2 means:**

    a) Weak internal position

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b) Average internal position

c) Strong internal position

d) External position

Answer: c) Strong internal position

15. **An EFE score of 1.7 on the IE Matrix indicates:**

a) High external position

b) Medium external position

c) Low external position

d) Strong internal position

Answer: c) Low external position

16. **Which of the following best describes a 'Star' in the BCG Matrix?**

a) Low market share, low growth

b) High market share, high growth

c) High market share, low growth

d) Low market share, high growth

Answer: b) High market share, high growth

17. **What is the main strategic implication of the IE Matrix?**

a) It determines marketing budgets

b) It guides grow, hold, or harvest strategies based on internal and external scores

c) It classifies products based on sales only

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d) It replaces the SWOT analysis

Answer: b) It guides grow, hold, or harvest strategies based on internal and external scores

18. **What strategy is generally recommended for divisions in cells VI, VIII, or IX of the IE Matrix?**

    a) Grow and build

    b) Hold and maintain

    c) Harvest or divest

    d) Expand aggressively

    Answer: c) Harvest or divest

19. **Which matrix plots business units on a 2x2 grid?**

    a) IE Matrix

    b) BCG Matrix

    c) SPACE Matrix

    d) TOWS Matrix

    Answer: b) BCG Matrix

20. **What assumption underlies the use of relative market share in the BCG Matrix?**

    a) Larger market share correlates with economies of scale and profitability

    b) Higher market share reduces profits

    c) Market share does not affect cash flow

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d) The smaller the market share, the better

Answer: a) Larger market share correlates with economies of scale and profitability

---

Short Questions & Answers

1. **Q:** What is the purpose of the Boston Consulting Group (BCG) Matrix?

   A: To analyze business units or products based on market growth rate and relative market share and to guide resource allocation.

2. **Q:** What are the four categories in the BCG Matrix?

   A: Stars, Cash cows, Question marks, and Dogs.

3. **Q:** What does a 'Cash Cow' represent in the BCG Matrix?

   A: A business unit with high market share in a slow-growing industry that generates more cash than needed.

4. **Q:** How is relative market share calculated?

   A: It is the brand's market share divided by the largest competitor's market share.

5. **Q:** What does the Internal-External (IE) Matrix measure?

   A: The internal strength (IFE score) and external opportunities/threats (EFE score) of an organization's divisions.

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6. **Q:** How many cells does the IE Matrix contain?

   A: Nine cells.

7. **Q:** What does a cell in the 'Grow and Build' region of the IE Matrix indicate?

   A: The division has a strong internal and/or external position and should focus on growth strategies.

8. **Q:** What scores on the IFE indicate a weak internal position?

   A: Scores between 1.0 and 1.99.

9. **Q:** Which IE Matrix cells suggest a 'Hold and Maintain' strategy?

   A: Cells III, V, and VII.

10. **Q:** Name one limitation of the BCG Matrix.

    A: It oversimplifies business units into four categories and ignores other important strategic variables.

LESSON 29 & 30

Lesson 29 & 30 on **Grand Strategy Matrix (GSM)** and **Quantitative Strategic Planning Matrix (QSPM**

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20 MCQs on Grand Strategy Matrix & QSPM (with answers)

1. **What are the two dimensions of the Grand Strategy Matrix?**

   a) Market share and profitability

   b) Market growth and competitive position

   c) Financial strength and industry stability

   d) Product quality and market share

   Answer: b) Market growth and competitive position

2. **Which quadrant of the Grand Strategy Matrix indicates a firm with a strong competitive position and rapid market growth?**

   a) Quadrant I

   b) Quadrant II

   c) Quadrant III

   d) Quadrant IV

   Answer: a) Quadrant I

3. **Which of the following strategies is typical for Quadrant II firms?**

   a) Forward integration

   b) Market penetration

   c) Joint ventures

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d) Retrenchment

Answer: b) Market penetration

4. **What is a common strategic recommendation for firms in Quadrant III?**

   a) Market development

   b) Retrenchment or liquidation

   c) Concentric diversification

   d) Forward integration

   Answer: b) Retrenchment or liquidation

5. **In which quadrant are firms encouraged to pursue diversification and joint ventures?**

   a) Quadrant I

   b) Quadrant II

   c) Quadrant III

   d) Quadrant IV

   Answer: d) Quadrant IV

6. **Which of the following is NOT a strategy found in Quadrant I?**

   a) Backward integration

   b) Liquidation

   c) Product development

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d) Market penetration

Answer: b) Liquidation

7. **The QSPM is primarily used in which stage of strategic management?**

   a) Strategy implementation

   b) Strategy formulation – decision stage

   c) Environmental scanning

   d) Strategy evaluation

   Answer: b) Strategy formulation – decision stage

8. **What is the first step in preparing a QSPM?**

   a) Assign attractiveness scores

   b) List key internal and external factors

   c) Identify alternative strategies

   d) Calculate total attractiveness scores

   Answer: b) List key internal and external factors

9. **In QSPM, the sum of weights assigned to internal and external factors must equal:**

   a) 0

   b) 0.5

   c) 1

   d) 10

   Answer: c) 1

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10. **What does an attractiveness score (AS) in QSPM represent?**

    a) Importance of a factor

    b) How well a strategy responds to a factor

    c) Financial impact of a strategy

    d) Time required to implement strategy

    Answer: b) How well a strategy responds to a factor

11. **Which matching matrices provide input to QSPM?**

    a) BCG, IE, TOWS, SPACE, Grand Strategy Matrix

    b) SWOT only

    c) CPM only

    d) Financial ratios only

    Answer: a) BCG, IE, TOWS, SPACE, Grand Strategy Matrix

12. **What is the best strategy to choose in a QSPM?**

    a) The one with lowest total attractiveness score

    b) The one with highest total attractiveness score

    c) The one suggested by the CEO

    d) The strategy with moderate score

    Answer: b) The one with highest total attractiveness score

13. **A limitation of QSPM is:**

    a) It requires intuitive judgments

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b) It ignores internal factors

c) It ignores external factors

d) It does not compare strategies

Answer: a) It requires intuitive judgments

14. **Which quadrant of the Grand Strategy Matrix is associated with weak competitive position and rapid market growth?**

    a) Quadrant I

    b) Quadrant II

    c) Quadrant III

    d) Quadrant IV

    Answer: b) Quadrant II

15. **Which of these is a typical strategy for Quadrant IV firms?**

    a) Market penetration

    b) Horizontal diversification

    c) Liquidation

    d) Retrenchment

    Answer: b) Horizontal diversification

16. **Retrenchment is most appropriate for which quadrant in the Grand Strategy Matrix?**

    a) Quadrant I

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b) Quadrant II

c) Quadrant III

d) Quadrant IV

Answer: c) Quadrant III

17. **Which is NOT a step in QSPM preparation?**

a) Assign weights to factors

b) List internal and external factors

c) Prepare financial statements

d) Assign attractiveness scores

Answer: c) Prepare financial statements

18. **What is the purpose of the Grand Strategy Matrix?**

a) To measure financial performance

b) To suggest alternative strategies based on competitive position and market growth

c) To calculate market share

d) To analyze stakeholder influence

Answer: b) To suggest alternative strategies based on competitive position and market growth

19. **Joint ventures are mainly recommended in which Grand Strategy Matrix quadrant?**

a) Quadrant I

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b) Quadrant II

c) Quadrant III

d) Quadrant IV

Answer: d) Quadrant IV

20. **Why is QSPM considered an objective tool?**

a) It uses only financial data

b) It numerically evaluates alternative strategies using weighted factors and attractiveness scores

c) It relies on CEO intuition

d) It ignores external environment

Answer: b) It numerically evaluates alternative strategies using weighted factors and attractiveness scores

---

10 Short Questions & Answers on Grand Strategy Matrix & QSPM

1. **Q:** What are the two axes of the Grand Strategy Matrix?

   A: Market growth rate and competitive position.

2. **Q:** What does Quadrant I of the Grand Strategy Matrix represent?

   A: Firms with strong competitive position and rapid market growth.

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3. **Q:** What strategic action is recommended for Quadrant III firms?

   A: Retrenchment, divestiture, or liquidation due to weak competitive position and slow growth.

4. **Q:** Name one strategy recommended for Quadrant IV companies.

   A: Concentric diversification or joint ventures.

5. **Q:** What is the key purpose of the QSPM?

   A: To objectively evaluate and select the best alternative strategy.

6. **Q:** What inputs are required for constructing a QSPM?

   A: Internal and external factors with weights and alternative strategies from matching matrices.

7. **Q:** How are weights assigned in QSPM?

   A: Based on the relative importance of each factor, summing to 1.

8. **Q:** What does a high total attractiveness score in QSPM indicate?

   A: The strategy is highly feasible and attractive.

9. **Q:** Why might a company fall into Quadrant II of the GSM?

   A: Because it has a weak competitive position but operates in a rapidly growing market.

10. **Q:** What is a limitation of the QSPM?

    A: It relies on intuitive judgments and quality of input data.

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LESSON 31

Lesson 31: The Nature of Strategy Implementation from Strategic Management (MGT603).

✓ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. What is the primary focus of strategy implementation?

A) Effectiveness

B) Intuition

C) Efficiency

D) Creativity

Answer: C) Efficiency

2. Which of the following is a key difference between strategy formulation and implementation?

A) Formulation is operational, implementation is intellectual

B) Implementation requires more intuitive skills

C) Formulation is an intellectual process; implementation is operational

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D) Implementation focuses only on planning

Answer: C) Formulation is an intellectual process; implementation is operational

3. What percentage of organizations fail to successfully execute their strategies, according to studies?

A) 30%-40%

B) 50%-60%

C) 70%-90%

D) 10%-20%

Answer: C) 70%-90%

4. What is a major reason why CEOs fail, according to Fortune Magazine?

A) Lack of capital

B) Poor marketing

C) Bad execution of strategy

D) Poor recruitment

Answer: C) Bad execution of strategy

5. Which of the following activities is part of strategy implementation?

A) Creating vision

B) Budget development

C) Identifying competitors

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D) Strategic analysis

Answer: B) Budget development

6. What type of skills are primarily needed for strategy implementation?

A) Analytical and research

B) Leadership and motivation

C) Technical and design

D) Marketing and finance

Answer: B) Leadership and motivation

7. Which level of management should be involved in both strategy formulation and implementation?

A) Only top managers

B) Only middle managers

C) Only functional managers

D) All levels of management

Answer: D) All levels of management

8. What is essential to minimize resistance during strategy implementation?

A) External hiring

B) Financial incentives only

C) Employee involvement

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D) Market segmentation

Answer: C) Employee involvement

9. What is the purpose of annual objectives?

A) Long-term planning only

B) Financial forecasting

C) Directing and channeling organizational efforts

D) Marketing strategy formulation

Answer: C) Directing and channeling organizational efforts

10. Annual objectives should conform to which framework?

A) SWOT

B) PEST

C) SMART

D) TOWS

Answer: C) SMART

11. Which of the following is a SMART objective?

A) Maximize sales soon

B) Improve service quality

C) Achieve 10% profit growth within 12 months

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D) Be the best in the industry

Answer: C) Achieve 10% profit growth within 12 months

12. Policies help in which of the following?

A) Creating new strategies

B) Formulating vision

C) Solving recurring problems

D) Setting corporate culture

Answer: C) Solving recurring problems

13. Which is a policy example mentioned in the lesson?

A) No formal dress code

B) Ban on employee promotions

C) No-smoking policy on a cruise ship

D) Mandatory remote work

Answer: C) No-smoking policy on a cruise ship

14. The top-down flow of communication helps to:

A) Reduce staff size

B) Develop bottom-up support

C) Eliminate competition

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D) Increase hierarchy

Answer: B) Develop bottom-up support

15. Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of a good annual objective?

A) Measurable

B) Ambiguous

C) Time-bound

D) Specific

Answer: B) Ambiguous

16. Policies serve as:

A) Mission statements

B) Tools for forecasting

C) Instruments for strategy implementation

D) Organizational goals

Answer: C) Instruments for strategy implementation

17. Objectives are useful in:

A) Increasing resistance to change

B) Avoiding competition

C) Allocating resources

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D) Selecting board members

Answer: C) Allocating resources

18. What percentage of directors in Times 1000 companies believe they implement strategy well?

A) 14%

B) 40%

C) 70%

D) 90%

Answer: A) 14%

19. Which of the following can hinder strategy implementation?

A) Clearly communicated goals

B) Lack of managerial support

C) SMART objectives

D) Employee training

Answer: B) Lack of managerial support

20. What does the "R" in SMART criteria stand for?

A) Realistic

B) Reliable

C) Relevant

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D) Radical

Answer: C) Relevant

📝 10 Short Question Answers

1. What is strategy implementation?

It is the process of turning strategic plans into actions to achieve desired business outcomes.

2. Why do many companies fail at strategy implementation?

Because of poor execution, lack of motivation, unclear communication, and insufficient involvement from employees.

3. How does strategy formulation differ from implementation?

Formulation is an intellectual and planning activity, while implementation is operational and action-oriented.

4. Name two examples of strategy implementation activities.

Hiring new employees and changing pricing strategies.

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5. What is the significance of involving middle managers in strategy?

It promotes commitment, reduces resistance to change, and improves communication and understanding.

6. What are annual objectives?

They are short-term goals aligned with long-term strategies to guide day-to-day operations.

7. List three characteristics of SMART objectives.

Specific, Measurable, Time-bound.

8. How do policies support strategy implementation?

They guide decision-making, standardize practices, and set boundaries for acceptable actions.

9. What role does communication play in implementation?

Clear communication from top management helps build support and understanding at all levels.

10. Why is employee training important for strategy implementation?

It equips employees with the necessary skills to meet strategic goals and perform effectively.

LESSON 32

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20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) on Resource Allocation & Conflict

1. **What is the first part of the resource allocation decision process?**
   - A) Choosing the project to allocate resources to
   - B) Setting the goals of the project
   - C) Choosing which items to fund in the plan
   - D) Identifying the resources needed

   Answer: C) Choosing which items to fund in the plan

2. **Which of the following is NOT a type of resource used in strategic management?**
   - A) Financial resources
   - B) Human resources
   - C) Political resources
   - D) Technological resources

   Answer: C) Political resources

3. **Which factor is commonly cited as a barrier to effective resource allocation?**
   - A) Too much focus on long-term financial goals
   - B) Overemphasis on short-run financial criteria
   - C) Clear strategic objectives
   - D) A strong organizational culture

   Answer: B) Overemphasis on short-run financial criteria

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4. **In the context of resource allocation, what is a contingency mechanism?**
    - A) Priority ranking of items to fund
    - B) Allocation of resources based on political priorities
    - C) A mechanism to decide which projects to abandon
    - D) A tool for identifying resource gaps

    Answer: A) Priority ranking of items to fund

5. **Which of the following types of conflict is most likely to be found in a work environment?**
    - A) Intrapersonal conflict
    - B) Community conflict
    - C) International conflict
    - D) Military conflict

    Answer: A) Intrapersonal conflict

6. **Which type of organizational structure is most suitable for large firms with diverse operations?**
    - A) Functional
    - B) Divisional by product
    - C) Divisional by geographic area
    - D) Matrix

    Answer: D) Matrix

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7. **In conflict management, what does the term "avoidance" refer to?**
   - A) Aiming for mutually beneficial solutions
   - B) Attempting to “win” the conflict
   - C) Allowing the other party to “win”
   - D) Trying to avoid the conflict entirely

   Answer: D) Trying to avoid the conflict entirely

8. **Which phase of conflict resolution is most difficult when values are the root cause?**
   - A) Identifying facts
   - B) Resolving assumptions
   - C) Proving values as "right"
   - D) Agreeing on common goals

   Answer: C) Proving values as "right"

9. **In resource allocation, which of the following is NOT typically a type of resource?**
   - A) Financial
   - B) Technological
   - C) Relational
   - D) Human

   Answer: C) Relational

10. **Which of the following is true about resource allocation in strategic management?**
    - A) It focuses on the short-term achievement of financial goals

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- B) It is only concerned with financial and technological resources
- C) It helps ensure that resources are allocated to the most important priorities
- D) It does not involve any contingency planning

Answer: C) It helps ensure that resources are allocated to the most important priorities

11. **Which of the following is NOT one of the primary types of conflict levels?**
    - A) Organizational conflict
    - B) Interpersonal conflict
    - C) Physical conflict
    - D) International conflict

    Answer: C) Physical conflict

12. **What is the main objective of the contingency mechanism in resource allocation?**
    - A) To ensure all projects receive the same funding
    - B) To reallocate resources if additional resources become available
    - C) To avoid prioritizing any particular project
    - D) To cut funding for high-priority projects

    Answer: B) To reallocate resources if additional resources become available

13. **When is the allocation of resources considered effective?**
    - A) When the total budget is reduced
    - B) When it matches the priorities established by annual objectives

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- C) When it is done without any strategic planning
- D) When it focuses only on short-term goals

Answer: B) When it matches the priorities established by annual objectives

14. **Which conflict type involves disagreements between individuals or groups within an organization?**
    - A) Interpersonal conflict
    - B) Organizational conflict
    - C) Group conflict
    - D) Intra-state conflict

    Answer: B) Organizational conflict
15. **Which type of conflict results from differing facts or assumptions?**
    - A) Conceptual conflict
    - B) Interpersonal conflict
    - C) Value conflict
    - D) Goal conflict

    Answer: A) Conceptual conflict
16. **Which of the following is the most common conflict response style when both parties seek mutual gain?**
    - A) Competing
    - B) Collaborating

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- C) Avoiding
- D) Accommodating

Answer: B) Collaborating

17. **How can structural changes influence strategy implementation?**
    - A) By simplifying the decision-making process
    - B) By making the strategy irrelevant
    - C) By creating new resources
    - D) By addressing ineffective organizational structures

    Answer: D) By addressing ineffective organizational structures

18. **What is the main problem with allocating resources based on political or personal factors?**
    - A) It leads to the optimal use of resources
    - B) It aligns resources with the organization's strategic priorities
    - C) It can undermine strategy execution and organizational goals
    - D) It guarantees effective strategy implementation

    Answer: C) It can undermine strategy execution and organizational goals

19. **Which of the following is a key component in resolving conflict over values?**
    - A) Creating consensus on factual matters
    - B) Avoiding conflict altogether
    - C) Using a facilitator to manage the conflict

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- D) Engaging in a competition of ideas

  Answer: C) Using a facilitator to manage the conflict

20. **What happens when there are too many levels of management in an organization?**
    - A) Strategy implementation becomes more efficient
    - B) It leads to more effective communication
    - C) There are often too many unachieved objectives
    - D) Decision-making becomes faster

      Answer: C) There are often too many unachieved objectives

---

10 Short Questions on Resource Allocation & Conflict

1. **What is the importance of resource allocation in strategic management?**
   - Resource allocation ensures that an organization's limited resources (financial, human, technological, physical) are distributed to the most important strategic priorities to achieve goals.
2. **What are the two main components of the resource allocation decision process?**
   - The basic allocation decision (which projects to fund) and the contingency mechanism (priority ranking of items to be funded if additional resources become available).
3. **How can organizational politics affect resource allocation?**

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- Political influences may lead to resources being allocated based on personal or political agendas rather than strategic objectives, harming the organization's overall effectiveness.

4. **What is the difference between intrapersonal conflict and interpersonal conflict?**
   - Intrapersonal conflict occurs within an individual, whereas interpersonal conflict happens between two or more people.
5. **What is a contingency mechanism in resource allocation?**
   - It is a plan for reallocating resources based on changes in circumstances, such as additional funding or cuts in the budget.
6. **What are some common barriers to effective resource allocation?**
   - Overprotection of resources, political influences, lack of strategic clarity, short-term financial focus, and reluctance to take risks.
7. **Why is conflict over values more difficult to resolve than conflict over facts?**
   - Because values are subjective and cannot be proven as "right" or "correct," making agreement on them challenging.
8. **What role does the organizational structure play in strategy implementation?**
   - The organizational structure should align with the strategy, as an ineffective structure can hinder successful strategy execution.
9. **How does conflict resolution differ in cooperative versus competitive situations?**

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- In competitive situations, the goal is often to "win," while in cooperative situations, the aim is to find mutually beneficial solutions.

10. **What happens when an organization's structure is no longer effective for its strategy?**
    - The organization may experience inefficiencies, poor communication, unresolved interdepartmental conflicts, and failure to meet objectives.

LESSON 33

Lesson 33 on Organizational Structure:

20 MCQs with Answers

1. **What is the primary characteristic of a functional structure?**
    - A) Divisions operate as independent profit centers
    - B) Employees are grouped based on their specific skills
    - C) Authority is decentralized
    - D) Decisions are made at the top levels
    - **Answer**: B) Employees are grouped based on their specific skills
2. **Which structure is best used when an organization has diverse products or markets?**

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- A) Functional Structure
- B) Divisional Structure
- C) Matrix Structure
- D) SBU Structure
- **Answer**: B) Divisional Structure

3. **What is a key disadvantage of a divisional structure?**
   - A) Duplication of services across divisions
   - B) High employee morale
   - C) Ease of decision-making
   - D) Low overhead costs
   - **Answer**: A) Duplication of services across divisions
4. **In which organizational structure are functional activities performed both centrally and within each division?**
   - A) Functional Structure
   - B) Divisional Structure
   - C) Matrix Structure
   - D) SBU Structure
   - **Answer**: B) Divisional Structure
5. **What is the main advantage of a strategic business unit (SBU) structure?**
   - A) Improved control at the top management level

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- B) Increased complexity and higher overhead costs
- C) Clear accountability and focus on strategic goals
- D) Limited autonomy for divisional managers
- **Answer**: C) Clear accountability and focus on strategic goals

6. **Which type of divisional structure is most appropriate for an organization with a broad geographic spread?**
   - A) Divisional by product
   - B) Divisional by geographic area
   - C) Divisional by process
   - D) Functional structure
   - **Answer**: B) Divisional by geographic area
7. **What is the main feature of a matrix structure?**
   - A) Simple lines of authority
   - B) Dual reporting channels
   - C) Decentralized decision-making
   - D) Centralized control
   - **Answer**: B) Dual reporting channels
8. **Which of the following is an advantage of the functional structure?**
   - A) Encourages cross-functional collaboration
   - B) Promotes specialization of labor

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- C) High flexibility in decision-making
- D) High employee morale
- **Answer**: B) Promotes specialization of labor

9. **Which structure would be most suitable for an organization that needs to focus on specific products?**
   - A) Functional Structure
   - B) Divisional by product
   - C) Matrix Structure
   - D) SBU Structure
   - **Answer**: B) Divisional by product
10. **What does restructuring primarily focus on?**
    - A) Redesigning processes to improve quality and service
    - B) Reducing the size of the firm to improve efficiency
    - C) Changing the organization's strategic direction
    - D) Improving employee well-being
    - **Answer**: B) Reducing the size of the firm to improve efficiency
11. **Which of the following is a key disadvantage of a matrix structure?**
    - A) High communication efficiency
    - B) Confusion due to dual reporting lines
    - C) Simple organizational design

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- D) Clear and direct authority channels
- **Answer**: B) Confusion due to dual reporting lines

12. **In which of the following is reengineering focused?**
    - A) Organizational downsizing
    - B) Redesigning work processes to improve cost, quality, and speed
    - C) Reducing the number of employees
    - D) Creating self-contained business units
    - **Answer**: B) Redesigning work processes to improve cost, quality, and speed
13. **Which of the following best describes the role of SBUs in large organizations?**
    - A) They have a highly centralized decision-making structure
    - B) They are independent profit centers that develop their own strategies
    - C) They share strategies with other divisions but have no control over their performance
    - D) They are controlled entirely by top management
    - **Answer**: B) They are independent profit centers that develop their own strategies
14. **Which organizational structure is most likely to cause confusion regarding authority?**
    - A) Matrix Structure
    - B) Functional Structure

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- C) Divisional Structure
- D) SBU Structure
- **Answer**: A) Matrix Structure

15. **What does e-engineering primarily involve?**
    - A) Improving internal communication
    - B) Redesigning processes using digital technology
    - C) Reducing the size of the organization
    - D) Downsizing departments for efficiency
    - **Answer**: B) Redesigning processes using digital technology
16. **What is one major advantage of divisional structures by customer?**
    - A) It allows companies to focus on specific product lines
    - B) It helps to tailor strategies to the needs of different customer groups
    - C) It reduces the duplication of services across divisions
    - D) It improves coordination in production processes
    - **Answer**: B) It helps to tailor strategies to the needs of different customer groups
17. **Which type of structure is best suited for large conglomerates with multiple, unrelated businesses?**
    - A) Functional Structure
    - B) Matrix Structure
    - C) SBU Structure

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- D) Divisional Structure
- **Answer**: C) SBU Structure

18. **Which of the following is a potential disadvantage of the divisional structure by product?**
    - A) High duplication of services
    - B) High employee morale
    - C) Increased accountability for divisional managers
    - D) Clear lines of authority
    - **Answer**: A) High duplication of services
19. **Which structure is considered the most complex in terms of management?**
    - A) Functional Structure
    - B) Divisional Structure
    - C) Matrix Structure
    - D) SBU Structure
    - **Answer**: C) Matrix Structure
20. **What is the goal of reengineering in an organization?**
    - A) To downsize the firm to improve efficiency
    - B) To improve cost, quality, service, and speed through process redesign
    - C) To establish clear accountability across divisions
    - D) To implement digital solutions across the organization

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- **Answer**: B) To improve cost, quality, service, and speed through process redesign

---

10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **What is a functional structure, and when is it most appropriate?**
   - A functional structure organizes employees based on specialized skills (e.g., marketing, finance). It's most appropriate when the organization focuses on producing uniform products with specialized processes.
2. **What is a divisional structure?**
   - A divisional structure organizes a company into self-contained units, with each division operating as a separate profit center. It can be organized by geography, product, customer, or process.
3. **What are the advantages of a divisional structure?**
   - Advantages include clear accountability, high employee morale, the ability to add new products easily, and improved local control over specific markets or products.
4. **Explain the concept of Strategic Business Units (SBUs).**

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- SBUs are independent units within a corporation that have their own strategy and objectives. They operate as separate businesses, with distinct goals from the parent company.

5. **What is the primary difference between restructuring and reengineering?**
   - Restructuring focuses on downsizing and organizational changes to improve efficiency, while reengineering is about redesigning processes and work to improve quality, service, and cost.
6. **What are the main disadvantages of the matrix structure?**
   - Disadvantages include dual reporting lines, potential confusion over authority, and high overhead costs due to complex management layers.
7. **When would an organization choose to use a divisional structure by customer?**
   - This structure is used when an organization serves multiple customer groups that require different services or strategies, like catering to different types of customers (e.g., commercial and individual clients).
8. **What does a matrix structure emphasize in an organization?**
   - It emphasizes both vertical and horizontal communication flows, allowing for more collaboration and flexibility in managing complex projects.
9. **What is the role of e-engineering in modern organizations?**
   - E-engineering involves redesigning business processes using digital technologies to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and enhance overall performance.

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10. **What challenges can arise when implementing a divisional structure?**
    - Challenges include increased costs due to duplication of services, potential difficulty in maintaining consistent practices across divisions, and the need for skilled managers to handle decentralized decision-making.

LESSON 34

Lesson 34: Restructuring

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20 MCQs with Answers

1. **What is restructuring primarily aimed at?**
    - a) Diversification
    - b) Increasing staff
    - c) Making the company more efficient and profitable
    - d) Expanding into new markets

    Answer: c) Making the company more efficient and profitable
2. **Which of the following is a common characteristic of restructuring?**
    - a) Expansion of operations
    - b) Reduction of staff

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- c) Increased wages for employees
- d) Increase in production capacity

Answer: b) Reduction of staff

3. **What is typically sold off in a company during restructuring?**
   - a) Profitable divisions
   - b) Underutilized assets
   - c) Core business units
   - d) Patents

   Answer: b) Underutilized assets

4. **Restructuring often results in a leaner, more efficient company with a focus on:**
   - a) Employee retention
   - b) Core business operations
   - c) Increased wages
   - d) Diversified business units

   Answer: b) Core business operations

5. **What is the major goal of reengineering?**
   - a) Increase workforce
   - b) Radical redesign of business processes
   - c) Expand business units

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- d) Increase profit margins

Answer: b) Radical redesign of business processes

6. **Which of the following is a key proponent of reengineering?**
   - a) Michael Hammer
   - b) Jeff Bezos
   - c) Mark Zuckerberg
   - d) Steve Jobs

   Answer: a) Michael Hammer

7. **Reengineering primarily involves focusing on:**
   - a) Reducing costs through layoffs
   - b) Vertical integration
   - c) Complete business processes rather than functional specialties
   - d) Sales expansion

   Answer: c) Complete business processes rather than functional specialties

8. **Which of the following is NOT a criticism of reengineering?**
   - a) It assumes inefficiency in processes without validation
   - b) It disregards the status quo entirely
   - c) It improves long-term financial performance
   - d) It does not focus on organizational constraints

   Answer: c) It improves long-term financial performance

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9. **What is a common outcome of implementing reengineering in a company?**
    - a) Improved employee morale
    - b) Increased cross-functional teamwork
    - c) Lowered production costs without downsizing
    - d) Increased product quality

    Answer: b) Increased cross-functional teamwork

10. **Which of the following best describes the concept of 'pay-for-performance'?**

- a) Offering employees a fixed salary regardless of performance
- b) Rewarding employees based on individual, group, or company-wide performance
- c) Providing bonus pay without performance targets
- d) Increasing salaries based on seniority

Answer: b) Rewarding employees based on individual, group, or company-wide performance

11. **What type of bonus system is typically used by DuPont Canada?**

- a) Profit-sharing
- b) Performance-based bonus system
- c) Seniority-based bonuses
- d) Equity compensation

Answer: b) Performance-based bonus system

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12. **Which of the following is a disadvantage of the reengineering process?**

- a) High employee turnover
- b) Massive layoffs and high resistance
- c) Complete integration of functions
- d) Increased job satisfaction

Answer: b) Massive layoffs and high resistance

13. **In terms of managerial roles, restructuring often leads to:**

- a) Increase in managerial salaries
- b) A reduction in management positions
- c) Higher job satisfaction
- d) Expansion of managerial responsibilities

Answer: b) A reduction in management positions

14. **What is the benefit of linking performance and pay to strategies?**

- a) Increased employee resistance
- b) It encourages alignment with organizational goals
- c) Decreased staff motivation
- d) Greater focus on employee well-being

Answer: b) It encourages alignment with organizational goals

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15. **Which of the following is a type of change strategy used in strategy implementation?**

- a) Rational change strategy
- b) Status-quo strategy
- c) Defensive strategy
- d) Proactive strategy

Answer: a) Rational change strategy

16. **Which strategy involves providing employees with information to convince them of the need for change?**

- a) Force change strategy
- b) Educative change strategy
- c) Rational change strategy
- d) Defensive change strategy

Answer: b) Educative change strategy

17. **What is one of the key considerations for managing resistance to change?**

- a) Speed of change
- b) Clear communication and information
- c) Eliminating all job positions

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- d) Increasing salaries across the board

Answer: b) Clear communication and information

18. **Which environmental issue often compels companies to re-evaluate their operations?**

- a) Pollution and global warming
- b) Employee dissatisfaction
- c) Technological innovation
- d) Expansion into new markets

Answer: a) Pollution and global warming

19. **Firms that adopt environmental strategies are likely to benefit in terms of:**

- a) Lower environmental standards
- b) Better relationships with stakeholders
- c) Increased operational costs
- d) Reduced product quality

Answer: b) Better relationships with stakeholders

20. **The natural environment in business refers to:**

- a) Business conditions created by human activity

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- b) The local workforce and economy
- c) Living and non-living things that occur naturally on Earth
- d) The global market environment

Answer: c) Living and non-living things that occur naturally on Earth

---

10 Short-Answer Questions

1. **Define restructuring and explain its primary purpose.**

   Answer: Restructuring refers to the process of reorganizing a company to make it more efficient and profitable. This typically involves selling off unprofitable divisions, reducing staff, and improving focus on core business operations.

2. **What are the key characteristics of restructuring?**

   Answer: Key characteristics include selling off underperforming assets, staff reductions, outsourcing operations, management changes, and refinancing corporate debt.

3. **Explain the difference between restructuring and reengineering.**

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Answer: Restructuring is focused on reorganizing the company's structure to improve profitability, while reengineering is the radical redesign of business processes to improve efficiency and reduce waste.

4. **What are some criticisms of the reengineering process?**

   Answer: Criticisms include its assumption that process inefficiency is the primary problem, its disregard for the status quo, and its failure to focus on an organization's constraints.

5. **How does reengineering promote cross-functional teamwork?**

   Answer: Reengineering emphasizes breaking down functional silos and encouraging collaboration across departments, which promotes a team-oriented approach to business processes.

6. **Describe the concept of "pay-for-performance" and its role in strategy alignment.**

   Answer: Pay-for-performance is a compensation system where employees are rewarded based on their individual, group, or company-wide performance. This helps align employees' goals with the company's strategic objectives.

7. **What is the advantage of using the educative change strategy for implementing new strategies?**

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Answer: The educative change strategy helps build employee commitment by providing them with information to understand and support the change process, leading to greater acceptance and lower resistance.

8. **What environmental factors should companies consider when managing environmental affairs?**

   Answer: Companies should consider factors like pollution control, resource conservation, waste management, climate change, and environmental sustainability in their operations.

9. **How can organizations manage resistance to change during restructuring?**

   Answer: Organizations can manage resistance by providing clear communication, involving employees in the change process, offering support during transitions, and ensuring that the reasons for change are well understood.

10. **Discuss the impact of global warming on business strategy formulation.**

Answer: Global warming requires companies to adopt more sustainable practices, reduce carbon footprints, and integrate environmental considerations into their business strategies to avoid negative public perception and legal risks.

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LESSON 35

Lesson 35: Production/Operations Concerns When Implementing Strategies

Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. **What percentage of a firm's total assets do production processes typically constitute?**

   A) 30%

   B) 50%

   C) 70%

   D) 90%

   Answer: C) 70%

2. **Which of the following is NOT a production-related concern when implementing a strategy?**

   A) Plant location

   B) Inventory control

   C) Customer service strategy

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D) Employee training

Answer: C) Customer service strategy

3. **What does Just-in-Time (JIT) inventory strategy help reduce?**

   A) Product quality

   B) Employee turnover

   C) In-process inventory costs

   D) Raw material costs

   Answer: C) In-process inventory costs

4. **Which company type would benefit most from production flexibility?**

   A) Steel manufacturer

   B) Biogenetics company

   C) Bank

   D) Fast-food restaurant

   Answer: B) Biogenetics company

5. **In JIT philosophy, inventory is viewed as:**

   A) A strategic asset

   B) A cost that adds value

   C) A hedge against risk

   D) A cost that does not add value

   Answer: D) A cost that does not add value

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6. **What is a major risk of Just-in-Time inventory systems?**

   A) High storage costs

   B) Inefficiency in production

   C) Depletion of inventory during unexpected demand surges

   D) Poor product quality

   Answer: C) Depletion of inventory during unexpected demand surges

7. **Which of the following is NOT a factor that needs to be studied when placing a plant?**

   A) Transportation costs

   B) Wage rates

   C) Employee social security benefits

   D) Political risks

   Answer: C) Employee social security benefits

8. **Cross-training of employees helps in strategy implementation by:**

   A) Increasing work overload

   B) Facilitating better communication

   C) Creating management conflicts

   D) Requiring fewer employees

   Answer: B) Facilitating better communication

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9. **A hospital implementing a product development strategy would most likely:**

   A) Purchase new equipment and hire specialists

   B) Open new locations

   C) Hire new marketing teams

   D) Merge with another healthcare provider

   Answer: A) Purchase new equipment and hire specialists

10. **What is the core idea of Just-in-Time (JIT) inventory philosophy?**

    A) Stockpile materials for later use

    B) Eliminate inventory that doesn't add value

    C) Increase production speed

    D) Keep large inventory reserves

    Answer: B) Eliminate inventory that doesn't add value

11. **Which of the following strategies would require adjustments in shipping, packaging, and transportation systems?**

    A) Market development

    B) Product development

    C) Diversification

    D) Cost leadership

    Answer: A) Market development

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12. **For high-tech companies, which of the following is typically more important than production costs?**

    A) Cost control

    B) Product flexibility

    C) Inventory management

    D) Facility expansion

    Answer: B) Product flexibility

13. **What is one of the main reasons for production system adjustments when strategies shift?**

    A) To increase product variety

    B) To maintain high production costs

    C) To meet shifting demands for product flexibility and cost

    D) To reduce production speed

    Answer: C) To meet shifting demands for product flexibility and cost

14. **What is one of the consequences of failure to match individuals' aptitudes with implementation tasks?**

    A) Increased productivity

    B) Disruption of social and political structures

    C) Reduced employee satisfaction

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D) Clearer strategic goals

Answer: B) Disruption of social and political structures

15. **A key factor in overcoming human resource issues during strategy implementation is:**

    A) Reducing employee wages

    B) Involving managers and employees in the process

    C) Cutting down on training programs

    D) Focusing only on upper management

    Answer: B) Involving managers and employees in the process

16. **Which of the following is a major cause of human resource problems during strategy implementation?**

    A) Lack of technology integration

    B) Inadequate top management support

    C) Overestimation of production capacity

    D) High marketing expenditure

    Answer: B) Inadequate top management support

17. **Employee stock ownership plans (ESOP) help link company performance with:**

    A) Employee work hours

    B) Employee compensation

    C) Operational costs

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D) Market share

Answer: B) Employee compensation

18. **Which of the following is NOT a factor when choosing a plant location?**

    A) Availability of resources

    B) Availability of skilled labor

    C) Number of competitors in the region

    D) Political risks in the area

    Answer: C) Number of competitors in the region

19. **Which production system is driven by a series of visual signals, such as the presence or absence of a part on a shelf?**

    A) Kanban

    B) SWOT

    C) Balanced Scorecard

    D) Gantt Chart

    Answer: A) Kanban

20. **A well-designed strategic-management system can fail if human resource issues such as _____ are not addressed.**

    A) Low employee turnover

    B) Disruption of social and political structures

    C) Excessive pay increases

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D) High inventory levels

Answer: B) Disruption of social and political structures

Short-Answer Questions

1. **What is Just-in-Time (JIT) inventory, and what is its main advantage?**

   Answer: JIT inventory is a strategy where materials are delivered to a production site only as they are needed, reducing in-process inventory costs. Its main advantage is cost reduction through minimized inventory holding.

2. **How does cross-training employees support strategy implementation?**

   Answer: Cross-training employees allows them to understand different aspects of the business, leading to improved communication, better problem-solving, and increased operational flexibility.

3. **Explain the concept of "plant location analysis" when implementing a market development strategy.**

   Answer: Plant location analysis involves assessing factors like transportation costs, market proximity, availability of skilled labor, and political stability to choose an optimal site for expansion.

4. **What is a major concern when a strategy involves adding new products to an organization's portfolio?**

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Answer: A major concern is purchasing specialized equipment and hiring specialized personnel to support the new product development.

5. **How can JIT inventory systems impact a company's return on investment?**

   Answer: JIT can improve ROI by reducing inventory costs, which frees up capital, improves cash flow, and enhances operational efficiency.

6. **Why is employee training important in strategy implementation?**

   Answer: Training ensures that employees have the necessary skills to carry out new tasks effectively, contributing to the successful implementation of a strategy.

7. **What is the role of human resource management in strategy implementation?**

   Answer: HR manages staffing needs, employee motivation, safety, and performance incentives to align workforce efforts with strategic goals.

8. **What is the relationship between a company's strategy and its production system?**

   Answer: A company's production system must adapt to its strategy to meet requirements for product flexibility, cost control, and operational efficiency.

9. **What challenges can arise from failure to match employees' skills with implementation tasks?**

   Answer: Disruption of workflow, decreased morale, and reduced efficiency can occur if employees are not suited for the tasks required by new strategies.

10. **How can human resource issues undermine the success of strategy implementation?**

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Answer: If HR issues such as lack of support from management or poor employee engagement are not addressed, it can lead to resistance, low morale, and reduced commitment to strategic goals.

LESSON 36

Lesson 36: Market Segmentation

Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. **What is the first step in target marketing?**

   A) Identifying different market segments and their needs

   B) Creating a product mix

   C) Developing a marketing communication strategy

   D) Deciding on the price

   Answer: A) Identifying different market segments and their needs

2. **Which of the following is a requirement for successful segmentation?**

   A) Homogeneity within segments

   B) Measurability and accessibility

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C) Profitable segment size

D) All of the above

Answer: D) All of the above

3. **What is a drawback of mass marketing?**

   A) Economies of scale

   B) Ignoring differing customer needs

   C) Increased customer satisfaction

   D) Broad appeal

   Answer: B) Ignoring differing customer needs

4. **Which segmentation base involves grouping customers by income, age, or occupation?**

   A) Psychographic

   B) Behavioral

   C) Demographic

   D) Geographic

   Answer: C) Demographic

5. **Which of the following is an example of psychographic segmentation?**

   A) Age

   B) Region

   C) Lifestyle

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D) Income

Answer: C) Lifestyle

6. **Which segmentation variable is related to customer behavior toward a product?**

   A) Demographic

   B) Psychographic

   C) Behavioral

   D) Geographic

   Answer: C) Behavioral

7. **What is "depth segmentation"?**

   A) Grouping customers based on demographics

   B) Using multiple variables to understand a market segment in-depth

   C) Simplifying the market by focusing on one variable

   D) Targeting only the largest market segments

   Answer: B) Using multiple variables to understand a market segment in-depth

8. **Which method is commonly used to determine a buyer profile?**

   A) Cluster analysis

   B) SWOT analysis

   C) PESTLE analysis

   D) BCG matrix

   Answer: A) Cluster analysis

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9. **What is a key benefit of market segmentation in strategy implementation?**

   A) Enables firms to use mass production techniques

   B) Reduces competition in the market

   C) Allows firms to operate with limited resources

   D) Ensures uniform product offerings

   Answer: C) Allows firms to operate with limited resources

10. **In which situation is market segmentation especially useful?**

    A) When a firm aims to serve all market segments

    B) When a firm has vast resources to compete

    C) When a firm focuses on specialized or small markets

    D) When there is no differentiation in customer needs

    Answer: C) When a firm focuses on specialized or small markets

11. **Which of the following is an example of behavioral segmentation?**

    A) Age

    B) User status

    C) Income level

    D) Education

    Answer: B) User status

12. **What does "Heterogeneity between segments" mean in market segmentation?**

    A) Customers in different segments have similar needs

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B) Segments should be different from each other

C) All customers within a segment should be alike

D) Customers in the same segment prefer the same product

Answer: B) Segments should be different from each other

13. **What type of segmentation involves categorizing customers based on where they live?**

A) Psychographic

B) Demographic

C) Geographic

D) Behavioral

Answer: C) Geographic

14. **What is the marketing mix's "Place" referring to in modern marketing strategies?**

A) Where the product is distributed geographically

B) The price of the product

C) The advertising channels used

D) The location of the production facility

Answer: A) Where the product is distributed geographically

15. **Which of the following segmentation methods focuses on grouping customers based on their attitudes and opinions?**

A) Behavioral segmentation

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B) Demographic segmentation

C) Psychographic segmentation

D) Geographic segmentation

Answer: C) Psychographic segmentation

16. **Which demographic segmentation variable groups people by family structure and stages of life?**

A) Age

B) Family lifecycle

C) Occupation

D) Income

Answer: B) Family lifecycle

17. **Which of the following is NOT a typical geographic segmentation variable?**

A) Region

B) Climate

C) Usage rate

D) Population density

Answer: C) Usage rate

18. **What is the main advantage of segmentation for smaller firms?**

A) It allows smaller firms to compete effectively with larger firms

B) It eliminates competition in the market

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C) It reduces product customization costs

D) It increases the complexity of the marketing campaign

Answer: A) It allows smaller firms to compete effectively with larger firms

19. **What is "Market Penetration" in the context of segmentation?**

A) Expanding into new markets

B) Selling new products to existing markets

C) Increasing sales in existing markets

D) Reducing product prices

Answer: C) Increasing sales in existing markets

20. **Why is segment accessibility important in market segmentation?**

A) It ensures the segment is reachable through appropriate distribution channels

B) It guarantees the segment is the largest in size

C) It simplifies pricing strategies

D) It reduces competition in the segment

Answer: A) It ensures the segment is reachable through appropriate distribution channels

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Short-Answer Questions

1. **What is market segmentation, and why is it important?**

   Answer: Market segmentation is the process of dividing a broad market into smaller, more manageable subgroups based on similar characteristics. It is important because it allows businesses to target specific customer needs, improve marketing efficiency, and enhance customer satisfaction.

2. **What are the four bases for consumer market segmentation?**

   Answer: The four bases are geographic, demographic, psychographic, and behavioral.

3. **What is the difference between mass marketing and target marketing?**

   Answer: Mass marketing treats the market as a homogeneous group and offers the same marketing mix to all customers. Target marketing, on the other hand, recognizes the diversity of customers and focuses on tailoring the marketing mix to different segments.

4. **What are the key requirements for successful market segmentation?**

   Answer: Key requirements include homogeneity within the segment, heterogeneity between segments, measurable and identifiable segments, accessible and actionable segments, and large enough segments to be profitable.

5. **How does behavioral segmentation differ from demographic segmentation?**

   Answer: Behavioral segmentation focuses on customer behavior towards products, such as benefits sought or usage rate, while demographic segmentation groups customers based on characteristics like age, income, or family size.

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6. **What is the purpose of cluster analysis in market segmentation?**

   Answer: Cluster analysis is used to group customers with similar characteristics into segments, helping to create detailed buyer profiles.

7. **How can segmentation help small firms compete with larger firms?**

   Answer: Segmentation allows small firms to focus their resources on targeted segments, maximizing per-unit profits and sales in niche markets, thereby competing effectively with larger firms.

8. **What is a "buyer profile" in market segmentation?**

   Answer: A buyer profile is a detailed description of the typical member of a market segment, which may include demographic, psychographic, and behavioral characteristics.

9. **How does market segmentation affect the marketing mix (Four Ps)?**

   Answer: Market segmentation helps businesses tailor the product, price, place, and promotion to meet the specific needs of different customer segments, improving the overall effectiveness of marketing strategies.

10. **Why is "accessibility" an important criterion in market segmentation?**

    Answer: Accessibility ensures that the segment can be reached through the appropriate distribution channels, promotional strategies, and pricing, which are crucial for successful implementation of the marketing strategy.

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LESSON 37

Lesson 37: Market Segmentation

✅ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) with Answers

1. **What are the four elements of the marketing mix?**

   A) Product, Price, People, Performance

   B) Product, Place, Price, Promotion ✅

   C) People, Promotion, Price, Process

   D) Product, Planning, Packaging, Promotion

2. **Who grouped the marketing mix into the 4 Ps?**

   A) Philip Kotler

   B) Neil Borden

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C) James Culliton

D) E. Jerome McCarthy ✓

3. **Which of the following is not a product decision?**

A) Styling

B) Warranty

C) Cash discount ✓

D) Packaging

4. **Which pricing strategy aims to attract customers with a low initial price?**

A) Skimming

B) Penetration ✓

C) Premium

D) Bundling

5. **Distribution decisions are mainly related to:**

A) Product packaging

B) Marketing budget

C) Transportation and warehousing ✓

D) Brand name

6. **Which of the following is NOT part of promotion in the 4 Ps?**

A) Public relations

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B) Sales promotion

C) Pricing strategy ✓

D) Advertising

7. **What does "Place" refer to in the marketing mix?**

A) Customer mindset

B) Communication style

C) Distribution channels ✓

D) Product style

8. **Which of the following is an example of promotional strategy?**

A) Exclusive distribution

B) Price discrimination

C) Push or pull approach ✓

D) Reverse logistics

9. **Which one is a part of product positioning strategy?**

A) Order processing

B) Market research

C) Positioning through cultural symbols ✓

D) Pricing flexibility

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10. **The goal of the marketing mix is to:**

    A) Maximize inventory

    B) Reduce product features

    C) Center decisions on customer value ✓

    D) Minimize advertising costs

11. **The term "marketing mix" was first used by:**

    A) E. Jerome McCarthy

    B) James Culliton

    C) Neil Borden ✓

    D) Michael Porter

12. **What does “positioning by product class dissociation” mean?**

    A) Aligning with leading brands

    B) Separating from competitors’ product category ✓

    C) Emphasizing low price

    D) Copying product features

13. **Which element is considered while designing a product-positioning map?**

    A) Cultural habits

    B) Advertising frequency

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C) Key differentiating criteria ✓

D) Distribution budget

14. **Positioning is mainly about how a product appears in relation to:**

A) Government standards

B) Competitor products ✓

C) Supplier brands

D) Employee perception

15. **A company can identify a market niche using a:**

A) Financial report

B) Positioning map ✓

C) Pricing matrix

D) Sales force feedback

16. **Which of the following is an example of price discrimination?**

A) Offering discounts to students ✓

B) Product warranty

C) Quality packaging

D) Using a cultural symbol

17. **Which is NOT a promotional tool?**

A) Advertising

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B) Personal selling

C) Warehousing ✓

D) Sales promotions

18. **Reverse logistics involves:**

A) Sending promotional emails

B) Handling product returns ✓

C) Processing orders

D) Expanding coverage

19. **Which of these is a step in developing a product positioning strategy?**

A) Hiring sales reps

B) Budgeting promotion

C) Plotting competitors on a positioning map ✓

D) Setting seasonal discounts

20. **Which strategy positions the product on customer needs or solutions?**

A) Usage occasion positioning

B) Benefit-based positioning ✓

C) Class dissociation

D) Pull promotion

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✅ 10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **Q: What is market segmentation?**

   A: It is the process of dividing a market into distinct groups of customers with similar needs or characteristics.

2. **Q: What are the 4 Ps of marketing mix?**

   A: Product, Price, Place, and Promotion.

3. **Q: What is product positioning?**

   A: It's how a product appears in the minds of customers relative to competing products.

4. **Q: Who introduced the concept of the 4 Ps in the marketing mix?**

   A: E. Jerome McCarthy.

5. **Q: What is the goal of marketing mix decisions?**

   A: To create perceived customer value and generate a positive response.

6. **Q: Give an example of product-based positioning.**

   A: Positioning a phone based on its camera quality.

7. **Q: What is price bundling?**

   A: Selling two or more products together at a combined price lower than if sold separately.

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8. **Q: What is exclusive distribution?**

   A: A strategy where a product is sold through a limited number of outlets.

9. **Q: What is reverse logistics?**

   A: The process of managing returned goods or recycling products.

10. **Q: What is a product positioning map?**

    A: A visual tool to compare products based on selected attributes and identify market gaps.

LESSON 38

Lesson 38 – Finance/Accounting Issues from *Strategic Management – MGT603*:

✓ 20 MCQs with Answers

1. **Which of the following is NOT a primary concern of finance in strategy implementation?**

   a) Hiring new employees

   b) Acquiring capital

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c) Preparing pro forma statements

d) Evaluating the worth of a business

→ a) Hiring new employees

2. **What does EPS stand for?**

   a) Equity per Share

   b) Earnings per Share

   c) Earnings per Strategy

   d) Enterprise Profit Share

   → b) Earnings per Share

3. **The Debt-to-Equity ratio helps measure:**

   a) Liquidity

   b) Profitability

   c) Leverage

   d) Operational efficiency

   → c) Leverage

4. **Which is a major tool for assessing whether to use debt or equity financing?**

   a) ROI analysis

   b) Break-even analysis

   c) EPS/EBIT analysis

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d) SWOT analysis

→ c) EPS/EBIT analysis

5. **Issuing new stock may lead to:**

   a) Reduced leverage

   b) Increased interest obligations

   c) Ownership dilution

   d) Increased liabilities

   → c) Ownership dilution

6. **Which financial statement shows forecasted future operations?**

   a) Historical balance sheet

   b) Income tax return

   c) Pro forma statement

   d) Cash flow reconciliation

   → c) Pro forma statement

7. **Financial budgeting is primarily concerned with:**

   a) Marketing planning

   b) Human resources

   c) Allocation of resources

   d) Legal compliance

   → c) Allocation of resources

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8. **Which method evaluates a firm based on its assets and liabilities?**

   a) Outstanding shares method

   b) Net worth approach

   c) Price-earnings ratio

   d) Market share approach

   → b) Net worth approach

9. **The earnings per share formula is:**

   a) Net income / Number of employees

   b) Gross profit / Net sales

   c) Net income / Number of outstanding shares

   d) Total assets / Equity

   → c) Net income / Number of outstanding shares

10. **A pro forma income statement forecasts:**

    a) Current tax liabilities

    b) Past cash flows

    c) Future earnings

    d) Dividend history

    → c) Future earnings

11. **Which of the following is not a type of financial budget?**

    a) Flexible budget

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b) Factory budget

c) Segmentation budget

d) Capital budget

→ c) Segmentation budget

12. **A firm's capital structure includes:**

a) Only liabilities

b) Assets and inventories

c) Debt and equity

d) Cash flows and expenses

→ c) Debt and equity

13. **Which is NOT a step in pro forma financial analysis?**

a) Forecast sales

b) Conduct environmental scanning

c) Prepare income statement

d) Project balance sheet items

→ b) Conduct environmental scanning

14. **What does EBIT stand for?**

a) Earnings Before Interest and Taxes

b) Economic Budget in Transition

c) Equity Before Internal Transfers

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d) Earnings Before Internal Taxes

→ a) Earnings Before Interest and Taxes

15. **Financial leverage is mainly measured by:**

a) ROE

b) EPS

c) D/E ratio

d) Net working capital

→ c) D/E ratio

16. **Which budgeting period is most commonly used?**

a) Monthly

b) Weekly

c) Annual

d) Quarterly

→ c) Annual

17. **A high D/E ratio typically means a company is:**

a) Low in debt

b) Highly leveraged

c) Not profitable

d) Paying high dividends

→ b) Highly leveraged

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18. **Which budget includes plans for machinery purchases?**

    a) Sales budget

    b) Capital budget

    c) Expense budget

    d) Cash budget

    → **b) Capital budget**

19. **Pro forma financial statements help in:**

    a) Tracking taxes

    b) Estimating company worth

    c) Projecting future financial performance

    d) Auditing previous records

    → **c) Projecting future financial performance**

20. **One limitation of budgeting is:**

    a) It encourages planning

    b) It reduces costs

    c) It can become too rigid and detailed

    d) It increases flexibility

    → **c) It can become too rigid and detailed**

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➥ 10 Short Question Answers

1. **What is the purpose of EPS/EBIT analysis?**

   → To determine the best method of financing (debt, equity, or both) based on its impact on earnings per share.

2. **Define Pro Forma Income Statement.**

   → It is a projected financial statement estimating future income, expenses, and profits.

3. **What are the two main sources of capital?**

   → Debt and equity.

4. **What does the debt-to-equity (D/E) ratio show?**

   → The proportion of a firm's financing from creditors compared to shareholders.

5. **What is financial budgeting?**

   → A method to allocate financial resources effectively to implement strategy.

6. **Mention any two types of financial budgets.**

   → Capital budget and flexible budget.

7. **List one benefit of using pro forma statements.**

   → Helps forecast future financial results and evaluate alternative strategic plans.

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8. **What is the price-earnings ratio method of valuation?**

   → It multiplies the firm's average net income by the P/E ratio to estimate firm value.

9. **What does a pro forma balance sheet show?**

   → The projected financial position of a company including future assets, liabilities, and equity.

10. **Name any one limitation of budgeting.**

    → Budgets can hide inefficiencies if based solely on past data.

LESSON 39

Lesson 39: Research and Development Issues from Strategic Management – MGT603:

✓ 20 MCQs with Answers

1. **What is a key disadvantage of going public?**

   A) Increased product development

   B) Reduced market exposure

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C) Loss of control and high initial costs ✓

D) Easier access to R&D funding

2. **Which condition is ideal for in-house R&D development?**

A) Rapid tech changes, fast market growth

B) Slow tech change, moderate market growth, high entry barriers ✓

C) Fast tech and slow market

D) Fast market and slow tech

3. **Which is NOT an R&D activity listed in the lesson?**

A) Adapting to local raw materials

B) Creating financial budgets ✓

C) Altering products to local tastes

D) Transferring complex technologies

4. **Which R&D strategy minimizes the risk and cost of innovation?**

A) First to market

B) Innovative imitator ✓

C) Low-cost producer

D) Market penetration

5. **A cosmetic company adding a face wash to its line is practicing:**

A) Market penetration

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B) Product development

C) Concentric diversification ✓

D) Horizontal integration

6. **Which type of firm should outsource R&D from external sources?**

A) Firms with slow market growth and slow tech

B) Firms with fast tech, fast market

C) Firms with slow tech and fast market ✓

D) Firms with no competition

7. **A firm aiming to be first to market is pursuing:**

A) Cost leadership

B) Differentiation

C) Innovation leadership ✓

D) Stability strategy

8. **What is the primary reason companies collaborate in R&D today?**

A) Decrease in product life cycles

B) High R&D costs and competitive pressure ✓

C) Lack of innovation

D) Scarcity of raw materials

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9. **Which department does R&D commonly conflict with?**

   A) Human resources

   B) Finance/accounting ✓

   C) Legal

   D) Production

10. **What is a common shareholder expectation from a public company?**

    A) 5% growth

    B) 10–15% growth ✓

    C) 2–3% growth

    D) 20–25% growth

11. **Going public helps a firm to:**

    A) Reduce debt

    B) Raise capital for expansion ✓

    C) Avoid government regulations

    D) Decrease transparency

12. **Which strategy requires strong R&D support?**

    A) Divestiture

    B) Retrenchment

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C) Product development ✓

D) Liquidation

13. **Which is an example of market penetration?**

A) Launching in new countries

B) Developing biodegradable containers ✓

C) Acquiring competitors

D) Rebranding

14. **R&D involvement is crucial in reducing:**

A) Supply chain issues

B) Greenhouse gas emissions ✓

C) Legal costs

D) Political risk

15. **Which R&D strategy requires strong marketing as well?**

A) First mover

B) Imitative innovator ✓

C) Low-cost leader

D) Franchise model

16. **Applied research focuses more on:**

A) Theory

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B) Practical implementation ✓

C) Philosophical ideas

D) Consumer behavior only

17. **Who performs R&D if contracted externally?**

A) Internal staff

B) Government agencies

C) Outside firms or universities ✓

D) HR department

18. **Which policy helps reduce interdepartmental conflict?**

A) Loose project deadlines

B) Clear R&D policies and objectives ✓

C) Eliminating marketing role

D) Centralizing budgeting

19. **Short product life cycles make R&D:**

A) Optional

B) Less significant

C) Crucial for survival ✓

D) Useless

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20. **Which is NOT a benefit of well-formulated R&D policy?**

    A) Matches market opportunities

    B) Ignores internal capabilities ✓

    C) Screens initial ideas

    D) Supports implementation

✍ 10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **What is the role of R&D in strategy implementation?**

   To develop new products or improve existing ones to align with strategic goals.

2. **What does "going public" mean in a strategic context?**

   It means offering company shares to the public to raise capital, often reducing owner control.

3. **Name one risk of being the first firm to market a new product.**

   The strategy is risky due to high development costs and uncertainty of market acceptance.

4. **What are the three major R&D strategies?**

   First-to-market, Innovative imitator, Low-cost producer.

5. **When is outsourcing R&D preferred?**

   When technology is stable but the market is growing quickly.

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6. **List one way R&D supports concentric diversification.**

   By creating complementary products, like a face wash for a cosmetic line.

7. **Why is collaboration rising in R&D?**

   Due to rising costs, complexity, and faster product development cycles.

8. **What makes R&D effective in organizations?**

   Alignment with strategic goals, interdepartmental coordination, and adequate resources.

9. **What is the advantage of being an innovative imitator?**

   Lower development risk by building on successful products.

10. **How can R&D help reduce greenhouse gas emissions?**

    By innovating in production processes or products that are environmentally friendly.

LESSON 40

Lesson 40: Strategy Review, Evaluation, and Control from Strategic Management – MGT603.

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✓ 20 MCQs with Answers

1. **What is the main purpose of strategy evaluation?**

   a) Cost reduction

   b) Employee satisfaction

   c) Alert management to problems in a timely fashion

   d) Increase market share

   Answer: c) Alert management to problems in a timely fashion

2. **Which of the following is *not* one of Richard Rummelt's four criteria for strategy evaluation?**

   a) Consonance

   b) Feasibility

   c) Profitability

   d) Consistency

   Answer: c) Profitability

3. **Porter's Five Forces model focuses on:**

   a) External macro environment

   b) Internal structure

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c) Microenvironment

d) Political factors

Answer: c) Microenvironment

4. **Which of the following is *not* one of Porter's Five Forces?**

   a) Threat of new entrants

   b) Bargaining power of customers

   c) Government regulations

   d) Threat of substitutes

   Answer: c) Government regulations

5. **Strategy evaluation is necessary because:**

   a) Environments are stable

   b) Strategies remain unchanged

   c) Environments are dynamic

   d) Employees demand it

   Answer: c) Environments are dynamic

6. **Which of these is part of the strategy-evaluation process?**

   a) Creating a mission statement

   b) Reviewing assumptions

   c) Raising capital

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d) Hiring new staff

Answer: b) Reviewing assumptions

7. **Which force in Porter's model deals with product alternatives in the market?**

   a) Threat of new entrants

   b) Rivalry

   c) Bargaining power of suppliers

   d) Threat of substitute products

   Answer: d) Threat of substitute products

8. **What is the final force influenced by the other four in Porter's model?**

   a) Economic performance

   b) Level of industry rivalry

   c) Government regulation

   d) Organizational structure

   Answer: b) Level of industry rivalry

9. **Which of the following evaluation criteria is concerned with adaptive response to trends?**

   a) Advantage

   b) Consistency

   c) Consonance

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d) Feasibility

Answer: c) Consonance

10. **Which criterion ensures that a strategy is achievable with available resources?**

    a) Advantage

    b) Consonance

    c) Consistency

    d) Feasibility

    Answer: d) Feasibility

11. **According to R.T. Lenz, when are organizations most vulnerable?**

    a) During a crisis

    b) At peak success

    c) During startup

    d) When hiring new staff

    Answer: b) At peak success

12. **Which force in Porter's model relates to buyer power and demand?**

    a) Bargaining power of customers

    b) Threat of substitutes

    c) Threat of new entrants

    d) Bargaining power of suppliers

    Answer: a) Bargaining power of customers

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13. **Which of these is a tool for strategy evaluation?**

    a) Product lifecycle

    b) SWOT

    c) Benchmarking

    d) Balanced scorecard

    Answer: c) Benchmarking

14. **Which evaluation method uses structured group forecasting?**

    a) SWOT

    b) Delphi Technique

    c) TOWS

    d) Strategic audit

    Answer: b) Delphi Technique

15. **A feasible strategy must not:**

    a) Provide competitive edge

    b) Overuse resources

    c) Involve planning

    d) Use internal talent

    Answer: b) Overuse resources

16. **Porter's Five Forces model is useful in evaluating:**

    a) Internal HR policies

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b) Industry competitiveness

c) Product pricing

d) Accounting methods

Answer: b) Industry competitiveness

17. **Corrective actions are part of which step in strategy evaluation?**

a) Developing mission

b) Measuring performance

c) Evaluating assumptions

d) Recruiting employees

Answer: b) Measuring performance

18. **Which force affects a firm's ability to obtain raw materials?**

a) Bargaining power of suppliers

b) Threat of substitutes

c) Bargaining power of customers

d) Industry rivalry

Answer: a) Bargaining power of suppliers

19. **The strategy-evaluation process should be:**

a) Annual

b) Ongoing

c) Occasional

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d) One-time

Answer: b) Ongoing

20. **Advantage in strategy evaluation means:**

    a) Following competitors

    b) Having superior resources or skills

    c) Lower costs only

    d) Complying with government policies

    Answer: b) Having superior resources or skills

➡ 10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **What is strategy evaluation?**

   It is the process of assessing and reviewing the performance and relevance of a strategy in achieving organizational goals.

2. **Why is strategy evaluation important?**

   It helps identify potential or actual problems and ensures the strategy aligns with internal and external changes.

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3. **Name the three basic activities in strategy evaluation.**

   1. Reviewing underlying assumptions, 2. Measuring performance, 3. Taking corrective actions.

4. **List Porter's Five Forces.**

   1. Bargaining power of customers, 2. Bargaining power of suppliers, 3. Threat of new entrants, 4. Threat of substitutes, 5. Industry rivalry.

5. **What is the purpose of Porter's Five Forces model?**

   To analyze the competitive forces that shape industry profitability.

6. **What does 'consistency' mean in strategy evaluation?**

   It refers to the alignment of goals and policies without conflicts or contradictions.

7. **What does 'feasibility' mean in evaluating a strategy?**

   The strategy should be realistic and achievable with the available resources.

8. **What is the difference between merit and worth in evaluation?**

   Merit is about general value; worth is about specific utility or importance.

9. **What is the role of benchmarking in strategy evaluation?**

   It helps compare performance with best practices or industry standards.

10. **Why should strategy evaluation be continuous rather than periodic?**

    Continuous evaluation allows for ongoing monitoring and quicker responses to changes or issues.

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LESSON 41

Lesson 41: Porter Supply Chain Model from *Strategic Management – MGT603*.

✅ Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs)

1. Who developed the Value Chain framework?

A) Henry Mintzberg

B) Michael Porter

C) Philip Kotler

D) Peter Drucker

Answer: B) Michael Porter

2. Which of the following is NOT a primary activity in Porter's Value Chain?

A) Inbound Logistics

B) Technology Development

C) Operations

D) Outbound Logistics

Answer: B) Technology Development

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3. What is the purpose of the Value Chain model?

A) To reduce the workforce

B) To increase product prices

C) To create value and competitive advantage

D) To outsource company functions

Answer: C) To create value and competitive advantage

4. What is included in Inbound Logistics?

A) Customer support and repairs

B) Packaging and assembly

C) Receiving and storing raw materials

D) Advertising and sales promotion

Answer: C) Receiving and storing raw materials

5. Which activity focuses on transforming inputs into final products?

A) Procurement

B) Operations

C) Marketing

D) Firm Infrastructure

Answer: B) Operations

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6. Which support activity includes recruitment and training?

A) Procurement

B) Technology Development

C) Human Resource Management

D) Firm Infrastructure

Answer: C) Human Resource Management

7. Which primary activity handles order fulfillment and transportation?

A) Outbound Logistics

B) Inbound Logistics

C) Marketing

D) Operations

Answer: A) Outbound Logistics

8. What does the service activity focus on?

A) Promotion and advertising

B) Customer support and upgrades

C) Product design

D) Cost analysis

Answer: B) Customer support and upgrades

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9. Which of the following is NOT a cost driver according to Porter?

A) Economies of scale

B) Employee satisfaction

C) Geographic location

D) Timing of market entry

Answer: B) Employee satisfaction

10. How can a firm create a cost advantage?

A) By increasing product prices

B) By hiring more staff

C) By reducing cost of value chain activities

D) By expanding marketing only

Answer: C) By reducing cost of value chain activities

11. What is "reconfiguration" in the context of the value chain?

A) Hiring new staff

B) Replacing all machinery

C) Making structural changes in the value chain

D) Firing unproductive employees

Answer: C) Making structural changes in the value chain

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12. Which of the following includes advertising and pricing?

A) Service

B) Procurement

C) Marketing and Sales

D) Technology Development

Answer: C) Marketing and Sales

13. Which support activity helps improve all other activities using innovation?

A) Technology Development

B) Human Resources

C) Service

D) Operations

Answer: A) Technology Development

14. Firm infrastructure includes all EXCEPT:

A) Legal and accounting

B) Transportation

C) Public affairs

D) Quality management

Answer: B) Transportation

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15. Which term refers to managing the entire value chain for competitive advantage?

A) Chain Management

B) Network Analysis

C) Supply Chain Management

D) Marketing Strategy

Answer: C) Supply Chain Management

16. Which cost driver refers to production efficiency with increased volume?

A) Economies of scale

B) Timing of entry

C) Vertical integration

D) Institutional factors

Answer: A) Economies of scale

17. Which activity deals with the acquisition of resources?

A) Procurement

B) Operations

C) Service

D) Inbound Logistics

Answer: A) Procurement

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18. What does vertical integration refer to?

A) Horizontal market expansion

B) Using third-party logistics

C) Controlling more stages of the supply chain

D) Increasing labor force

Answer: C) Controlling more stages of the supply chain

19. Which cost driver relates to coordination between functions?

A) Learning

B) Institutional factors

C) Linkages among activities

D) Capacity utilization

Answer: C) Linkages among activities

20. What is the concept of "Value Network"?

A) Outsourcing all business processes

B) Physical and broader interconnection of value chains

C) Marketing partnerships only

D) Legal agreements between suppliers

Answer: B) Physical and broader interconnection of value chains

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✅ Short Questions with Answers

1. What is the main goal of Porter's Value Chain model?

Answer: The main goal is to analyze internal company activities to identify where value is added and to gain competitive advantage.

2. Name the five primary activities in the Value Chain.

Answer: Inbound Logistics, Operations, Outbound Logistics, Marketing and Sales, and Service.

3. What are support activities in Porter's model?

Answer: Procurement, Technology Development, Human Resource Management, and Firm Infrastructure.

4. How can a firm gain cost advantage using the Value Chain?

Answer: By reducing the cost of value-adding activities or by reconfiguring the value chain.

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5. What is meant by "reconfiguring the value chain"?

Answer: It refers to making structural changes like adopting a new production process or distribution channel to reduce costs or increase value.

6. Define “Inbound Logistics.”

Answer: It includes activities like receiving, storing, and managing the raw materials required for production.

7. What role does Technology Development play in the Value Chain?

Answer: It supports other activities through innovation, R&D, and process improvements.

8. How does Human Resource Management add value?

Answer: By recruiting, training, and retaining skilled employees, it enhances productivity and supports organizational goals.

9. What are "cost drivers" in the context of Porter’s model?

Answer: They are factors that influence the cost of performing value chain activities, like economies of scale, location, or capacity utilization.

10. Why is Supply Chain Management important in Value Chain analysis?

Answer: It ensures efficient integration and management of all linked value chains, helping improve competitiveness and reduce waste.

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LESSON 42 & 43

Lessons 42 and 43 on *Strategy Evaluation and Reviewing Bases of Strategy* from **Strategic Management – MGT603**:

✓ 20 MCQs with Answers

1. **Which of the following is *not* one of Richard Rummelt's four criteria for evaluating strategies?**

   a) Feasibility

   b) Accuracy

   c) Consistency

   d) Advantage

   → b) Accuracy

2. **Which strategy evaluation criterion focuses on ensuring that goals and policies are not in conflict?**

   a) Consonance

   b) Advantage

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c) Consistency

d) Feasibility

→ c) Consistency

3. **The need for strategies to respond to external environmental trends relates to which criterion?**

   a) Advantage

   b) Consonance

   c) Feasibility

   d) Consistency

   → b) Consonance

4. **Which of the following *best* describes feasibility?**

   a) Creating a competitive advantage

   b) Matching goals with policies

   c) Matching strategy with available resources

   d) Adapting to market trends

   → c) Matching strategy with available resources

5. **What is a key difficulty in evaluating strategies today?**

   a) Too many customers

   b) Simplicity of the environment

   c) Increase in environmental complexity

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d) Fewer strategic variables

→ c) Increase in environmental complexity

6. **What is the purpose of taking corrective actions in strategy evaluation?**

   a) To abandon current strategies

   b) To conduct financial audits

   c) To reposition the firm competitively

   d) To maintain the status quo

   → c) To reposition the firm competitively

7. **Which of the following is *not* typically part of the strategy evaluation process?**

   a) Forecasting currency exchange rates

   b) Taking corrective actions

   c) Measuring organizational performance

   d) Reviewing bases of strategy

   → a) Forecasting currency exchange rates

8. **A revised EFE Matrix focuses on:**

   a) Changes in organizational departments

   b) Changes in external threats and opportunities

   c) Changes in mission statement

   d) Capital budgeting

   → b) Changes in external threats and opportunities

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9. **A revised IFE Matrix focuses on:**

   a) External threats

   b) Management and internal functions

   c) Governmental policies

   d) Competitor pricing

   → **b) Management and internal functions**

10. **Which of the following is an example of a qualitative evaluation criterion?**

    a) Return on equity

    b) Earnings per share

    c) Market share

    d) Internal consistency of strategy

    → **d) Internal consistency of strategy**

11. **What financial ratio is commonly used in evaluating strategy?**

    a) Inflation rate

    b) Return on investment

    c) Exchange rate

    d) Gross national product

    → **b) Return on investment**

12. **Which of the following can lead to strategy evaluation failure?**

    a) Continuous monitoring

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b) Limited number of variables

c) Forecasting accuracy

d) Rate of obsolescence of plans

→ d) Rate of obsolescence of plans

13. **What is corporate agility?**

a) Ignoring strategic change

b) A firm's ability to adapt to dynamic environments

c) Ability to produce low-cost goods

d) Outsourcing all functions

→ b) A firm's ability to adapt to dynamic environments

14. **What is the benefit of continuous strategy evaluation?**

a) Delays corrective action

b) Encourages employee resistance

c) Keeps strategists close to the organization's pulse

d) Eliminates the need for forecasting

→ c) Keeps strategists close to the organization's pulse

15. **Which factor *does not* usually require corrective action?**

a) Effective strategy implementation

b) Unexpected economic downturn

c) Poor supplier performance

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d) Declining market demand

→ **a) Effective strategy implementation**

16. **Which qualitative factor indicates employee dissatisfaction?**

a) High market share

b) High absenteeism

c) Strong balance sheet

d) Profit margin growth

→ **b) High absenteeism**

17. **What makes quantitative criteria less reliable?**

a) They are always outdated

b) They ignore qualitative inputs

c) Different accounting methods may give different results

d) They are too subjective

→ **c) Different accounting methods may give different results**

18. **Which question helps evaluate strategy consonance?**

a) Are we using our strengths?

b) Are we aligned with external trends?

c) Are we internally consistent?

d) Are we exceeding our budget?

→ **b) Are we aligned with external trends?**

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19. **What is an early signal that strategy evaluation may be needed?**

    a) Achievement of long-term objectives

    b) Employee satisfaction

    c) Failure to achieve annual objectives

    d) High market capitalization

    → c) Failure to achieve annual objectives

20. **Which concept did Alvin Toffler associate with overwhelming organizational change?**

    a) Corporate agility

    b) Future shock

    c) Strategic drift

    d) Market turbulence

    → b) Future shock

✍ 10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **What are the four criteria for evaluating strategies according to Richard Rummelt?**

   Ans: Consistency, Consonance, Feasibility, and Advantage.

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2. **What is the purpose of reviewing the bases of strategy?**

   Ans: To determine if internal and external factors that form the basis of strategy have changed and whether strategies need adjustment.

3. **Why is continuous strategy evaluation important?**

   Ans: It ensures ongoing alignment with objectives, allows quick corrective actions, and keeps the organization adaptive.

4. **What are common causes of strategic failure?**

   Ans: Poor implementation, over-ambitious objectives, environmental changes, ineffective strategies, and lack of employee involvement.

5. **What does the term 'corporate agility' mean?**

   Ans: The ability of an organization to adapt quickly and effectively to dynamic and complex changes in the business environment.

6. **Name any three quantitative criteria used in evaluating strategy.**

   Ans: Return on investment, Profit margin, Market share.

7. **What is the role of the revised EFE Matrix in strategy evaluation?**

   Ans: It assesses how effectively the organization is responding to external opportunities and threats.

8. **Why are qualitative criteria necessary in evaluating strategies?**

   Ans: They account for human factors, strategic alignment, and managerial judgment that are not captured by numbers alone.

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9. **What kind of changes may result from corrective actions?**

   Ans: Organizational restructuring, personnel changes, mission revisions, resource reallocation, or strategic reformulation.

10. **What is the impact of employee participation in strategy evaluation?**

    Ans: It reduces resistance to change and improves acceptance of corrective actions by fostering understanding and ownership.

LESSON 44 & 45

Lesson 44 and 45 from Strategic Management – MGT603, covering *Measuring Organizational Performance* and *Strategy Evaluation Systems*:

✓ 20 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) with Answers

Measuring Organizational Performance and Evaluation Systems

1. **Which of the following is NOT a commonly used quantitative criterion for evaluating strategies?**

   A. Return on Investment

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B. Debt to Equity Ratio

C. Employee Satisfaction

D. Sales Growth

Answer: C

2. **Which financial ratio measures how much profit a company makes for every dollar of shareholders' equity?**

   A. ROI

   B. EPS

   C. ROE

   D. Market Share

   Answer: C

3. **Which qualitative question evaluates the compatibility of the strategy with internal resources?**

   A. Is the strategy internally consistent?

   B. Is the strategy consistent with the environment?

   C. Is the strategy appropriate in view of available resources?

   D. Is the strategy workable?

   Answer: C

4. **Which issue does NOT directly influence strategy evaluation?**

   A. Competitor reaction

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B. Sales data

C. Time taken for production

D. Quality of raw material supplier's marketing

Answer: D

5. **What is the primary purpose of strategy evaluation?**

A. Increase employee turnover

B. Ensure financial ratios are equal

C. Monitor progress and make corrective actions

D. Ignore deviations from the plan

Answer: C

6. **What is a key characteristic of a good evaluation system?**

A. Complex and rigid

B. Delayed reporting

C. Action-oriented

D. Focus only on senior managers

Answer: C

7. **Which organization is responsible for conducting government audits?**

A. IRS

B. SEC

C. UN

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D. CPA

Answer: A

8. **Which system allows daily or hourly financial closing using computers?**

   A. QuickBooks

   B. SAP

   C. Virtual Close

   D. Oracle

   Answer: C

9. **What is the first step in contingency planning?**

   A. Monitor early warning signals

   B. Specify trigger points

   C. Identify beneficial and unfavorable events

   D. Develop advance action plans

   Answer: C

10. **Why is qualitative data important in strategy evaluation?**

    A. It reduces employee morale

    B. It focuses only on profits

    C. It considers human factors like satisfaction and turnover

    D. It prevents the need for quantitative evaluation

    Answer: C

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11. **Which factor is NOT part of the strategy evaluation process?**

    A. Examining the bases of strategy

    B. Implementing strategy

    C. Comparing actual and expected results

    D. Taking corrective actions

    Answer: B

12. **Which of the following is a disadvantage of relying solely on quantitative evaluation?**

    A. Simplicity of results

    B. Annual objective bias

    C. Focus on customer needs

    D. Encourages innovation

    Answer: B

13. **Which one is NOT a financial ratio used in strategy evaluation?**

    A. Market Share

    B. Turnover Rate

    C. Return on Investment

    D. Earnings per Share

    Answer: B

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14. **Which term refers to a process of objectively evaluating economic assertions and communicating results?**

    A. Auditing

    B. Consulting

    C. Forecasting

    D. Marketing Research

    Answer: A

15. **Who usually performs internal audits in organizations?**

    A. Independent firms

    B. Government regulators

    C. Internal employees

    D. Journalists

    Answer: C

16. **A good evaluation system should NOT be:**

    A. Simple

    B. Restrictive

    C. Timely

    D. Meaningful

    Answer: B

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17. **Which of the following is a qualitative criterion for evaluating strategy?**

    A. Return on Equity

    B. Profit Margin

    C. Strategy's risk level

    D. Asset Growth

    Answer: C

18. **Which benefit is NOT associated with contingency planning?**

    A. Prevents panic

    B. Encourages rigid strategy

    C. Promotes adaptability

    D. Enables quick response

    Answer: B

19. **Which of the following is true about computer-based evaluation systems?**

    A. They replace judgment completely

    B. They are useless in strategic evaluation

    C. They help enhance human decision-making

    D. They ignore data accuracy

    Answer: C

20. **What is the cornerstone of effective strategy evaluation?**

    A. Managerial power

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B. Performance bonuses

C. Timely feedback

D. Product innovation

Answer: C

✍ 10 Short Questions with Answers

1. **Q: What are the three critical comparisons used with financial ratios in strategy evaluation?**

   A: (1) Performance over time, (2) Performance vs. competitors, (3) Performance vs. industry averages.

2. **Q: Mention any four financial ratios commonly used in evaluating strategies.**

   A: Return on Investment (ROI), Earnings per Share (EPS), Debt to Equity, Market Share.

3. **Q: Why is it important to use qualitative criteria in strategy evaluation?**

   A: Because they capture human factors and non-financial elements like employee satisfaction and production quality.

4. **Q: What is contingency planning in strategic management?**

   A: It involves preparing alternative strategies to respond to unexpected events or changes.

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5. **Q: List any two qualities of an effective evaluation system.**

   A: Timely information and action-oriented reports.

6. **Q: What is the primary goal of an audit in strategy evaluation?**

   A: To ensure financial statements are accurate and align with set standards and policies.

7. **Q: What is the Virtual Close system?**

   A: A software by Cisco that enables daily or hourly financial reporting.

8. **Q: Why is simplicity important in an evaluation system?**

   A: Because complex systems can confuse users and reduce effectiveness.

9. **Q: What are the three basic activities involved in strategy evaluation?**

   A: (1) Examine strategy bases, (2) Compare actual vs. expected results, (3) Take corrective actions.

10. **Q: What is the main limitation of computer-based evaluation systems?**

    A: They cannot process human values, emotions, and judgments.

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